

趴趴雅思 2022.5-8 月口语题库高分参考答案

说明：目前题库已经基本稳定，此题库适用于 5-8 月考试。趴趴根据5月口试的情况，整理出了雅思口语考试完整版的题卡， P1 一共有10 道新题和 20道保留题，Part 2&3 一共有 18 道新题和 25 道保留题，口语题库基本稳定。

特别提示：素材内容仅供参考，请勿直接背诵。因为传播很广，在考场上很有可能考官听到类似的素材而影响你的分数。建议您参考思路，并修改形成自己的答题思路进行回答。p3 没有题库，仅提供部分收集到的问题进行展示回答思路。

如需要可直接背诵更完整版的口语素材请淘宝搜索“趴趴口语素材”，一个话题提供 10 个版本的素材供您选择，备考效率更高，且可以在考场上直接使用。

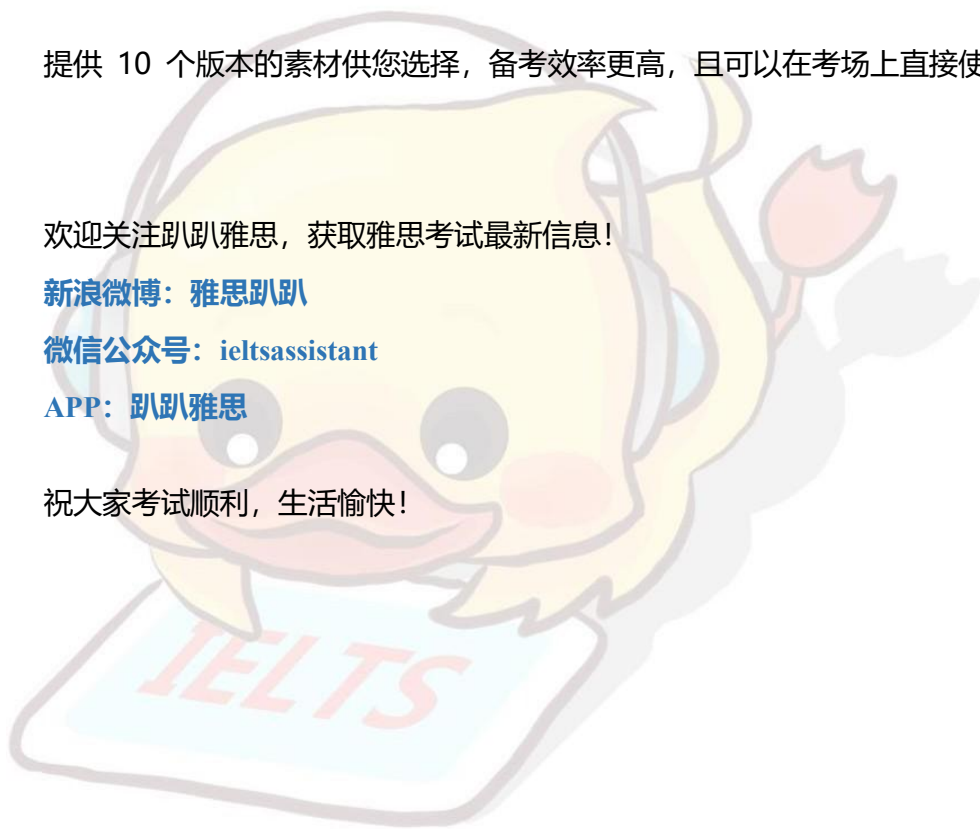
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多年的一线教学，也让趴趴沉淀出了自身独特教学体系，并编有专业书籍在册，备受雅思考生追捧。

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那么现在，就和趴趴一起开始高效备考之旅吧~



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P1 新题

1. Boring things

1、 What kinds of things are boring to you?

Well, I suppose I'm different from many people of my age. I find computer games and phone games particularly boring. I can't understand why people would spend that much time in it. Cause to me, I feel games are just manipulating people's minds and behaviors.

2、 What will you do when you feel bored?

When I'm idle, I like to pick up a novel to read, or sometimes watch animal documentaries. It's fascinating to see how different animal species manage to survive on our planet. I get intrigued by such topics and forget all about the boredom right away.

3、 What was the most boring thing you did when you were young?

Perhaps it was sleeping in class. Honestly, when I was in high school, I was not a very active student. I was going through my terrible puberty and I especially hated school. So I slept through about every math class. Now looking back, that's probably the most boring and silly thing I ever did.

4、 Do you think school is boring?

I don't think so anymore. In fact, I find school stimulating! In school, I could meet so many mind-alike people and make friends with them. Plus, the school offers great learning resources. I could also study in-depth whatever I am interested in. It's not boring at all.

2. Watch

1、 Do you wear a watch?

Sometimes, not always. I do often wear a watch in summer. I think a watch is better looking than a bracelet. I own several watches of different styles and colors to match my summer clothes. But I never wear a watch in winter, 'cause it feels cold touching my wrist.

2、 Have you ever got a watch as a gift?

Not that I can remember. I paid for every watch that I own. Actually, I don't think it's a good idea to receive a watch as a present. In my culture, either you buy a super expensive watch, as a piece of luxury investment, to give to someone important, or you don't give a watch as a gift at all. 'cause common watches aren't lucky gifts.



3、 Why do some people wear expensive watches?

As I just mentioned, these luxurious watches aren't treated as time-telling machines, but rather a piece of jewelry. Usually, people wear expensive jewelry to show off their great fortune, social status, or just to match their fancy clothes, I think.

4、 Do you think watch is important for you? Why?

Not really. Watches aren't necessary ornaments for me at all. If it's for checking the time, I can totally read the time on my phone. On the other hand, I'm not like rich or anything, so I have nothing to show off by a watch. So watches are not must-have items for me.

3. Collecting things

1、 Do you collect things?

Yes, of course. I may not be an environmentalist, but I do as much recycling as possible. Collecting things to use them multiple more times is a great way to protect our planet. Also, it helps me save money. I don't see why I should not do it.

2、 Are there any things you keep from childhood?

I have a bamboo cradle which I used throughout my childhood. I still have it now in my bedroom. The cradle was hand made by my grandfather. It's solid, concrete, and classic. It's especially cool in summer. I love it. Maybe when I have children, they can still use it.

3、 Would you keep old things for a long time? Why?

If it's something valuable, or has special meanings, of course I would keep them for a long time. Just like the cradle I just mentioned, it's still of great use. I use it as a container to contain my daily clothes now. It's almost like a closet. And in

the future, I can pass it down to my own children. So old things like this are worth keeping.

4、 Where do you usually keep things you need?

I keep my necessities in places that can be easily reached. I have bought dozens of plastic containers online with transparent covers. My cosmetics, medicines, stationery, and socks are kept in different containers and with labels.

4. Talents

1、 Do you have a talent, or something you are good at?

Well, I guess I'm good at organizing things. My mother intentionally trained me to be well-organizing when I was a kid. This skill helped me grow so efficient at work and study. I usually only use half of the time others need to sort things out.

2、 Was it mastered recently or when you were young?

Well, I was trained to do so when I was about five years old. My mother was a lawyer. She was sharp and logical. She trained me to be independent, and the ability to organize was the first skill she trained me to have.

3、 Do you think your talent can be useful for your future work? Why?

Absolutely. I believe it will benefit me a great deal in my future work because time is money. If I can save time, I can get more work done. Then, of course, I will be more efficient. It will also help me balance work and life in the future, I believe.

4、 Do you think anyone in your family has the same talent?

Yeah, definite. My mother is also good at sorting things out. She organizes things so neatly and clearly. Her work is always done perfectly. Sometimes I wonder if she's got a chip in her brain as she could manage to organize everything so scientifically.

5. Old buildings

1、 Have you ever seen some old buildings in the city?

Yes, I have. Usually the old buildings are people's houses in the old street. Some of these houses look pretty splendid. The design signals the family's grand past. However, they don't look quite safe anymore, since our government forbids

residents from rebuilding their houses unless it's the government's plan.

2、 Do you think we should preserve old buildings in cities?

Absolutely! The old buildings witness the city's past, and represent the family's history. They deserve to be preserved. Also, architecture is a form of art. Despite being historic, some houses look really aesthetic! It'd be wonderful if we could do something to protect them.

3、 Do you prefer living in an old building or a modern house?

To be honest, my ideal living place is an old building which can be redone as how I wish. Personally, I am a big history fan. I like to read history books, and I will admit that I have a fascination with antiques, including antique houses. Modern houses, for some reason, just don't appear attractive to me.

4、 Are there any old buildings you want to see in the future? Why?

Yeah, well, my parents are building a house in the mountain in my hometown. I've seen the pictures of the building. It looks like heaven! My folks said they used durable materials to build this house, so I wonder what it will look like in ten or twenty years, as they said I could inherit this place when they grow older.

6. Sitting down

1、 Where is your favorite place to sit?

Ah, that's an interesting question. Whenever it's possible, I always choose the seat next to the window, 'cause I enjoy the window view. It could be on the train, the bus, the plane or in a cafe. I suppose I just don't like to be contained in a closed space. Looking outside help me unwind.

2、 Do you always sit down for a long time?

Sometimes. I usually sit for long hours when I study or read. Once I encounter an interesting book, I wouldn't want to be interrupted until I finish my reading. So I like to find a quiet spot, like the corner of my bedroom or the library, and sit there for the whole afternoon.

3、 Do you feel sleepy when you are sitting down?

Not really, unless it's noon time. And it also kinda depends on what I do when I'm sitting there. If I'm watching my favourite show, no way that I would doze off. However, if I'm faced with a mathematical quiz. I'm afraid I would indeed.

4、 When you were a kid, did you usually sit on the floor?

I suppose I did. When I was young, my family lived in a house in the village. There were doorsteps where I always crawled back and forth. And 'cause my parents were so busy, they often just put me on the floor with a bunch of toys. Yeah, I definitely sit on the floor a lot.

7. Computers

1、 In what conditions would you use a computer?

Well, unlike a lot of young people who play games on the computer, I only use the computer for watching shows, and writing essays. I know these things can be done on the phone as well, but I just can't stand looking at the small screen for a long time. So I choose the computer instead.

2、 When was the first time you used a computer?

That's when I was about 15 years old, my mother signed me up for a summer course where they taught me how to type fast on the computer. To be honest, that was the first time I had a chance to use the computer.

3、 What would your life be like without computers?

Ah, I don't know. I'm sure it would be much less convenient than it is now. Not that I am an Internet-addict, but it does great help to my study and work. Without it, I think I wouldn't be as efficient as I am now. So yeah, my life would be difficult without it, I suppose.

4、 In what conditions would it be difficult for you to use a computer?

Oh, I've never thought about this. As long as I can access a computer, it's fine using it. But there were times when I got sore eyes. That's because I stared at the screen for too long. Yeah, well, when my eyes aren't dealing with the screen, I find it hard to use the computer.

8. Meeting places

1、 Where is your favorite places to meet with people?

Ah, I think the cafe is a good place for appointments, whether with friends, family, or classmates. The atmosphere in the cafe is often relaxing. The coffee smell can calm people down, and make people want to talk. I think it's a good place for a chat, yeah.

2、 Do you think there are some places more suitable for meeting with others?

Absolutely. Even though many people like to meet with friends or colleagues in a restaurant, I really think the tea house, cafe, and some small clubs can be better places for such meetings. You see, products in these places aren't very expensive. Also, the atmosphere is often great for socializing.

3、 Are there any differences between your favorite meeting places in the present and in your childhood?

Of course! When I was a child, my favorite place to go was the ice cream shop. If somebody was taking me to the ice cream store, I'd be thrilled! And I could totally fall in love with this person. However, now, I like to visit cafes or tea houses, as these places are comfortable to sit down for a chat.

4、 Why are some meeting places better than others?

Well, I guess that's because some places have a better atmosphere that's more suitable for socializing. You know, a pleasant environment can contribute to quality interactions. However, in places that are noisy, smelly or dirty, like the seafood market, I imagine people wouldn't even want to stay for long, let alone sit down for a chat.

9. Advertisements

1、 Are you interested in watching TV advertisements or internet advertisements?

I can't really say which one I prefer, 'cause I don't pay much attention to any types of ads. If I have to answer this question, I suppose I watch more internet

advertisements than TV commercials though, since I hardly ever watch any TV. Those internet ads that are interesting are often those with a few comedy plots in them.

2、What kinds of advertisements do you dislike?

I don't like ads that promote computer games. For some reason, I just find computer games such a waste of time. The game planners design games to manipulate the players' minds and behaviors. I don't think highly of that at all. So I don't like internet ads which involve inviting people to play games.

3、Do you share advertisements with others?

Only occasionally. I am kinda interested in nutrition supplement products. So sometimes when I see a relative ad, I may share it with my family, especially the ones related to Calcium, as both of my parents often get sore knees and are advised by the doctors to take Calcium supplement.

4、Do you want to work in advertising in the future?

That sounds like a promising proposal! I would if I could! I 'm fairly interested in psychology, especially behavioral psychology. I'm intrigued to find out people 's inner desires and what pushes them to make shopping decisions. So if I have the opportunity to work in this industry, I don't mind giving it a try.

10. Evening time

1、Do you like the morning or evening?

I'm a morning person. I like to get up early, do some morning exercises and then start my day fresh. I'm always more productive in the morning and can get most things done before lunch. However, in the evening, I can easily doze off.

2、What do you usually do in the evening?

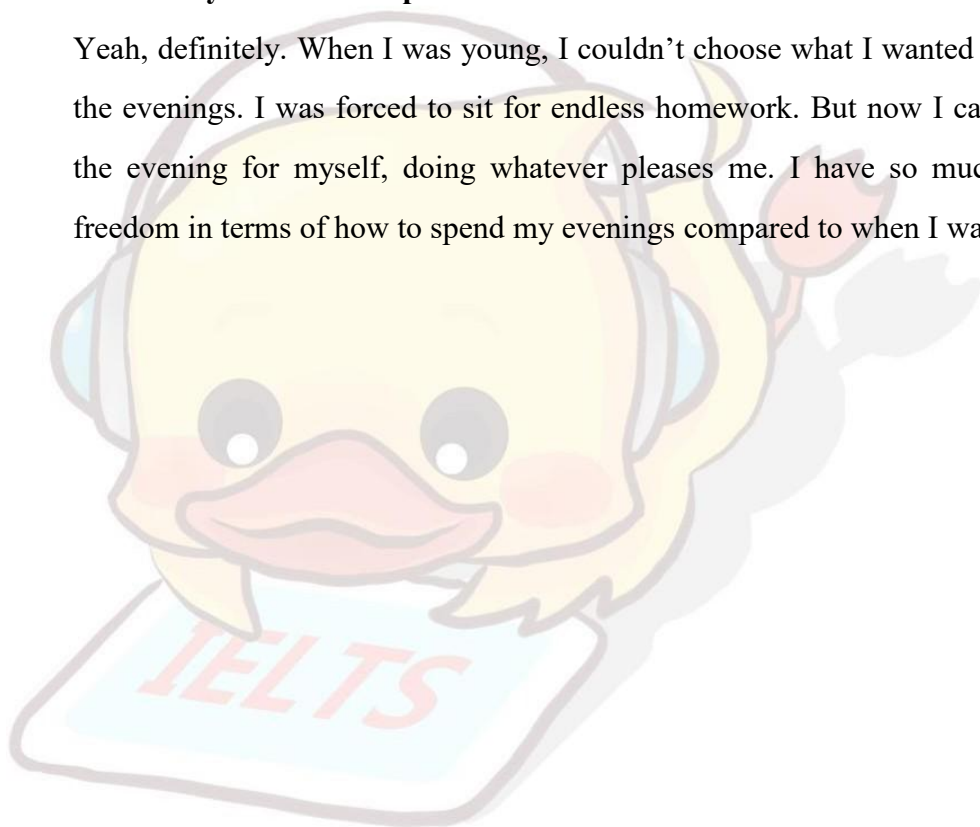
I'm a morning person. I like to get up early, do some morning exercises and then start my day fresh. I'm always more productive in the morning and can get most things done before lunch. However, in the evening, I can easily doze off.

3、What did you do in the evening when you were little? Why?

When I was a child, I spent most of my evenings doing homework. Even today, I can't quite understand why the teachers would give so much homework to children. I think spending all evenings in front of the study desk was deteriorating my health, mentally and physically.

4、Are there any differences between what you do in the evening now and what you did in the past?

Yeah, definitely. When I was young, I couldn't choose what I wanted to do in the evenings. I was forced to sit for endless homework. But now I can spend the evening for myself, doing whatever pleases me. I have so much more freedom in terms of how to spend my evenings compared to when I was a kid.



P1 保留题

1. Memory

1 、 Why do some people have good memory while others just don't?

Actually, gender differences can affect remembering. Scientist once concluded that generally females remember things better than males do. It might be because that females are more emotional than males so they could remember things more in detail.

2、 Why do more people rely on cellphones to memorize things?

I think it's because that this is a more efficient way to remember things. You don't need to waste time trying so hard to remember things with your brain, and then worry about forgetting at any minute. Just type in the data in your phone, and technology will help you remember all, which saves you a lot of time and energy.

3、 Are you good at memorizing things?

Not at all. My family and friends like to call me "Ma Da Ha", which in Chinese means a careless person. I often forget to do what I should do, or bring what I should bring. I am also very worried about my forgetful character but I just don't know how I could change.

4 、 Have you ever forgotten something that was important?

I still remember that it was during the New Year's Day holiday two years ago, I took my 5-year-old cousin to the supermarket near my home. After we finished shopping and started to walk home, I got a phone call from my friend and I started to chat with her with full attention. Until I got home did I realize that I totally forgot about my little cousin, and he didn't follow me back home. I immediately went out to look for him and I found him by the playground in the neighborhood.

2. Mobile phone

1、Do you often use your mobile phone for texting or for calls?

Well, it depends on what matter it is that needs to be discussed on the phone. If it's a serious issue, I usually just dial someone's number and speak to him/her directly. However, if it's just casual business and I'm not expecting a quick reply, I would just send a text message.

2、Do you remember your first phone?

Yeah, absolutely. My first cellphone was a gift from my father. When I was accepted by university, my father was super happy. He took me to the phone store to pick a cell phone for myself. It was a Nokia phone, of absolutely solid quality. At the time, I thought it looked pretty, and Nokia was like the most popular phone brand back then. I loved that phone!

3、Will you buy a new one in the future?

I think I will, definitely. As technology evolves so quickly, phones get old quickly too. Each year, there are hundreds of new versions of phones put out in the market. Each brand sells their products hard. I mean, I am just an ordinary consumer. I do get affected by their hard promotion. So even my phone is still working, I may replace it next year. Also, 'cause personally, I am quite a big follower of new technologies, I like to experience the newest functions on the phone. So yeah, I am very likely to buy a new phone in the near future.

4、How has your mobile phone changed your life?

Well, to start with, it made my life much easier and more efficient, for sure. I used to make trips to my friends' places when I wanted to have a word. But since I had a phone, I never needed to waste the time on travelling. I could just call them, or text them to communicate. I could even make video calls if I'm

away from my family. So yeah, it allows me to save time and manage my social life in a more productive way. Also, I can play games on my phone when I'm bored. It really helps to pass time. I feel that the mobile phones have made my life more fulfilled.

3. Daily routine



1、What is your daily study routine?

On weekdays, I get up at about 7:30 in the morning and finish washing. If there is no class in the morning, I will go to the library to study by myself. After lunch, I will take time to review the contents learned in the morning and prepare the items needed for the afternoon course. I usually don't choose to study immediately after dinner. I think people need a certain time to relax every day. Proper rest can make my brain cells more active. From 9:00 to 12:00 in the evening is my most efficient time, so most of my homework will be completed within this time period.

2、Have you ever changed your routine?

I will change my habits periodically. There are two reasons. First, I think the invariable life will make people feel bored and even tired gradually. Life needs a certain freshness, which is more important for students. The dull study life needs some adjustments. Second, the courses of each semester are different, so the change of time management is also indispensable, especially for the schedule of extracurricular discussion and social communication, which is the focus that contemporary students need to weigh more.

3、Do you think it is important to have a daily routine for your study?

Yes. As far as I know, successful people of the past and present are known to have a daily routine. For example, Steve Jobs, Benjamin Franklin and Elon Musk.

A daily routine easily eliminates distractions because people are focused only on those things that need to be done. As for students, the more they keep to their daily routine, the more automatic it becomes for them to perform all the activities throughout the day. As a result, their study becomes smooth and efficient.

4、 What part of your day do you like best?



There is an old Chinese saying goes: "work at sunrise and rest at sunset." People can make contributions to society, family and themselves only when they are sober. I personally like the moment when I get up in the morning, because it means that I want to start a day's study and work, which means that I will achieve a brand-new achievement for myself. Even if I just learn a little new knowledge or achieve a small goal, these are all footprints on the road of my life.

4. Lost and found

1、 What will you do if you find something lost by others?

If I found it in a certain area like an office building or a mall, I would contact the administrative staff for help. If I found it in public, I would check the lost item for personal information to see whether I could get in touch with the owner. If not, I would wait at the place where I found it for a reasonable period since I understand the frustration of losing things.

2、 Have you ever lost things?

I' m going to say it' s a weird no, not that I could remember of. Possibly I have lost some insignificant documents or receipts, but never have I ever lost any essential items. My mom loves to keep things tidy, to the extent of obsessive behaviour. So I was raised to keep everything organized and attended. Although I do once lose my wallet to a pocket picker.

3、Do you report to the police when finding something lost by others? Why ?

I can't really recall a time when I report to the police for finding other people's

lost items. For one, I rarely find other people's things. And for another, when I do find the lost items, they were usually just cheap ones, such as a hat, a coat, or books. It's really not worth going to the police station. However, if I ever find an expensive item, such as a purse, I think I better just call the police. It's not only about the money. But usually people keep their personal treasures with them, like the ID card, credit cards, or maybe important receipts. It will help the owner a great deal to have these things back.

4、 Will you post on social media if you lose your item?

Yes and no. It depends on what I've lost, really. If it's something common, I think it's a good idea to post it on social media like Wechat or Blog, and I would also ask my friends to post it for me as well. For example, I've lost an important textbook and got it back with the help of social media. However, if it's something very personal and may cause other people to guess about me, I definitely wouldn't use the social media. Last summer I lost my shampoo that treats hair loss. I don't want people on the social media know what kind of hair problems I have. So no, no posts.

5. Street market

1、 What do people usually buy on the street market?

A lot. I would buy gadgets like nail clippers or sponge mops. Also, accessories on the street markets are affordable and durable. I would buy hair rings or earrings or rings. Haha, it seems like I really love round objects. Generally, people shop for items with low prices on a street market since a street market could hardly provide customer service. And products with a brand would not be distributed to a street market.

2 、 Do you prefer to go shopping in the shopping mall or on the street market?

It depends. Personally, I shop with a list, so I would go to a shopping mall where it's for certain I could get everything I want for once. Also shopping in a mall would hardly be affected by weather unless it's a hurricane and all public places would be shut down. But if I'm hanging out with a friend, we would take a walk to a street market wandering.



3、When was the last time you went to a street market?

I just went to one Last Christmas. Shanghai was quite festive and several street markets were hosted. I went to one with friends. It was crowded. We had hot mulled wine and some pancakes. Many booths are selling festival decorations, but they were all overpriced and replaceable. E-commerce is very convenient in China so I tend to shop for unique goods on a street market.

4、Are there many street market in China?

Absolutely yes. Street markets are one of the main features in Chinese cities. In fact, we are so used to them that we can't imagine our cities without the street stalls. The most common type of street market is the food market. When night falls, in the corners of every city, I bet you, there are street food markets open. These markets attract so many customers 'cause they sell good food at cheap prices. They also sell clothes and groceries at the street market, but I don't think clothes and groceries sell as well as food.

6. Street food

1、Do you like to buy/taste street food?

I'm not a particular fan of street food. Most of the time I buy street food as the only available option. For example, if I'm catching a plane and could only eat in a taxi, I would grab a burrito or something on the street. Or when I'm too hungry to go to a restaurant, I would buy something on the street. Yet as much as I'm not in favor of it, still it tastes good enough most of the time.

2、What kind of street food do you like?

I have a very Asian stomach so I love carbs. I like street foods with rice, like onigiri or fried noodles. To be more specific, I like hot food. So, I prefer a traditional Shanghai food called Zifantuan, it's basically the same with onigiri or sushi but heated. It's quite an enjoyment to hold something hot in hand and feel it on your tongue. It's almost like feeling it burning in your body providing energy.

3、Do you like to buy street food when you travel to a new place?

Not really. I don't travel much, therefore I would use my limited time to enjoy the most. I would stay in five-star hotels and eat in elegant places with a chef. Arguably, street food is not inferior in taste. But I would pursue full enjoyment during a vacation so I would not eat in the open air. If street food could be served in a fancy room, I would say yes but that's a bit bizarre.

7. Time management

1、How do you plan your time in a day

Normally I would start my day with some cardio exercises. I always try to squeeze some time into working out. I'm not after a certain goal like getting muscular or skinny, but to feel being in control of my body. During working hours, I use a time management method called the time-management matrix. By classifying matters to be done by their urgency and importance, I could prioritize meaningful deeds and be more productive.

2、Is it easy to manage time

With the right methodology, I would argue it is. The vital part is to identify the nature of your tasks and to avoid distractions. For example, answering a small talk phone call is not necessarily more important than replying to a greeting

email from a customer regardless of the immediacy of a phone call. Therefore should one devote more concentrated time to handling professional affairs and the efficiency would save you more personal time.

3、 Is it hard to allocate time

In most of the cases, no. Usually, in preplanning, flexible time would be allocated in advance to cope with unexpected events. Sensible persons in charge would think of all possible scenarios so that wise time allocation would be proposed. If under a challenging circumstance with rather limited time, the expectation on the final result would be correspondingly less demanding, hence time allocation could simply focus on the essential part of the task.

4、 Do you like being busy?

I really don't. To me, getting busy usually means I have too much work or study to juggle. When I have too much on my plate, I can easily lost focus and get frustrated. Well, I know that some people are versatile and they can work on multiple tasks at one time. But I am just not that kind of people, unfortunately. Too much work drives me nuts! And I find it hard to keep myself balanced. So I prefer to have some spare time for myself apart from dealing with work or study affairs.

8. Emails

1、 Do you often send emails

Yes, I certainly do. With the help of emails, I am able to contact people all over the world without the boundary that domestic apps often have. And I do send email on serious cases like applying for a job or an internship, because companies always think email is a formal way to contact.

2、 When would you send emails to others

I often use email when applying for a job or an internship. By using emails, I can attach my CV and intentional letter to the mail. Meanwhile, I sometimes use emails to contact my international friends because they seldom use WeChat. Due to the restriction of internet, people in different countries find it difficult to use foreign apps.



3、 Is sending emails popular in China

Yes. In China, most people still consider email as the best way to talk about serious issues and exchange formal information. Recruiters always use emails to receive CVs so that he can select. Universities also use emails to collect applications for better convenience. Professors often ask students to send their paper by email. For them, email is good way to protect privacy by avoiding giving personal contact.

4 、 Do you think sending emails will be more or less popular in the future

Honestly speaking, I do think it will become less popular. As more convenient software emerges, people can send pictures and download files without using emails. But I think emails still hold its users and will never lose its significance in the future, because it's so far considered as the most formal way to communicate by the public.

9. Cinema

1、 Did you usually go to the cinema when you were a kid

No, I did not. When I was a kid, I do not like movies at all because there were very limited cartoon movies in the cinema. As a kid, I was only interested in cartoons, such as Card Captor Sakura, Detective Conan and Sailor Moon. None of them were shown on the big screen in the cinema.

2、 Do you usually go to the cinema with your friends

Yes, I do. My best friend and I are the big fans of Marvel, especially the Avengers. Therefore, we often go to the cinema to watch Marvel movies together. As soon as a new Marvel movie is released, we will definitely rush to the cinema with popcorn and Coke ready. Before the pandemic, we usually go to the cinema once a month, but recently, as the limitation of foreign movies is tightened and the effects of the pandemic, I go to the cinema with my friends about every three months.

3、 Do you still like watching the movie which you liked when you were a kid

Not anymore. When I was a kid, I enjoyed comedy and cartoon movie a lot because I liked what could make me laugh. I believed that watching movies only brings pure happiness. However, when I grow older, I find that there are so many complicated emotions and relationship among human beings, and I fell in love with tragedy, such as Titanic. Therefore, I seldom watch movies that I liked when I was a kid now.

4、 Do you prefer watching movies at home or at the cinema?

I prefer to watch movies at home. At the cinema, there are many unwanted distractions, such as cries of kids, ringtones, people who go to the restroom walking passing you. I am annoyed when I get interrupted while watching a movie. Furthermore, I prefer to curl up in a sofa while watching movies, which is not realistic at the cinema.

10. Websites

1、 What kinds of websites do you usually use?

As a student, the most frequently used website is search engines. Personally, I like Google the most but unfortunately it is not available in mainland China. Alternatively, I use Bing as my major search engine because its simple and elegant interface and precise search results. I do not like Baidu, because the

search results are often biased and interrupted by its paid services.

2、Are there any changes about the websites you usually use?

Yes, a lot of changes in search engine websites. In terms of user experience, Bing and Baidu are working on optimizing the search experience by adding more intelligent recommendations for keywords. Also, Baidu has launched a new function to search by images powered by artificial intelligence. This is amazing because I can identify unknown flowers or insects by a click.

3、What is your favourite website?

Oh that's hard to pick, 'cause I access so many websites every day. I visit online shopping websites, travelling websites, learning websites and etc. Among those, there is one called QiongyouEr that I especially like. Well, it's a travelling website, sorta like Tripadvisor.com, except this one offers trip advice to people who aren't rich, mainly college students and new graduates. That website targets at young people who love to explore new places and share their experience with other travelers. I'm just one of these people. So I log in this website about every day to read the traveling blogs written by others. It's such a treat for me!

4、What kinds of websites are popular in your country?

Well, I haven't thought about this before. If you walk on the street, you are very likely to see advertisement posts of the shopping websites, especially the ones that focus on take-away food. Yep, Meituan must be the most popular website in China at the moment. This website has attracted thousands of business so you can use the delivery service for food, medicine, fruits, snacks and groceries. There are also coupons on this website whenever there's a festival. Not only young people love this website, but the elderly log in this website too.

11. Sports

1、Do you usually watching sports programs on TV?

No, I do not usually watch sports programs. However, I often watch NBA with my friends about three or four times a year because I really enjoy watching and discussing basketball games with my friends, enjoying snacks and beers. But when I am alone, I do not usually watch sport games because I am more into tv shows comparing to sports.



2、Do you watch live sports games?

I do watch live Olympic games. I prefer live games because it gives me excitement and nervousness at the same time. My favourite live sport game is diving competition because I really appreciate how beautiful the dives are. Also, the uncertainty brought by live games lures me into keeping watching.

3、Who do you like to watch sports games with?

I would like to watch sports games with my best friend whom I knew in basketball club. He and I have kept in close relationship since we met for the first time because we have a lot interest in common. We both love to watch sports games, so I especially like to watch with him for we could discuss the skills and strategies together, we support the same team and we often cheer for them on our own way.

4、What kinds of games do you expect to watch in the future?

As time goes by I find myself becoming more easily interested in those exciting sports such as diving. I think the more challenging the sports are, the stronger will players may get, so I decide to learn to dive in this summer. But before that, I expect to watch many diving sports games online in the future in order to study and imitate the basic postures.

12. Mirrors

1、 Do you like looking at yourself in the mirror? How often?

Yes, I do. I feel that I become more confident when I am looking at myself in the mirror when I am feeling good. I look at the mirror about five to six times a day - in the morning when I brush my teeth, when I go to the bathroom several times during daytime, and when I start my skincare routine before going to bed.

2、 Have you ever bought mirrors?

Yes, I have bought a big mirror that is half a meter across and 1.8 meter high. I place it behind my door, so that I can look straight into it when I try to pick my outfit for the day. If I did not buy a mirror for myself, I need to share a mirror in the bathroom with my roommate, which is not very convenient. I'm so glad that I have my own mirror now.

3、 Do you usually take a mirror with you ?

No, I do not. In the past, I bought a pocket-size mirror, hoping that I could check my appearance any time. However, I found myself always forgot to take this mirror with me when I went out. When I stay at home, I have bigger mirrors in my room. Thus, the pocket-size mirror is just a waste of money.

4、 Would you use mirrors to decorate your room?

No, I would not use mirrors as decorations. I prefer to hide the mirrors even it is in my room and I need to use it very often because I feel scared if I accidentally glance at myself in the mirror. Also, at night, when I wake up, I do not want to see anything usual in the mirror. That would be really terrifying. Instead, I want to use flowers and paintings to decorate my room.

13. Dreams

1、 Do you often remember your dreams?

I believe everyone has his or her own dreams.Martin Luther king has been famous for the speech named I Have a Dream.He is one of the heroes whom I admire.So I always tell myself to keep it in mind that dream is what I live up to.Personally I want To be an interpreter in the future. To make it come true I insist reading and writing English over two hours each day.I believe to remember dream is the first step to realize it.



2、 Are you interested in others dreams?

Definitely the answer is yes and I assume it is true to most people.For me I have several dreams in different areas. My career dream is to become an excellent interpreter like the famous diplomatist Zhang Lu,which inspires me a lot throughout school years.Besides I also dream of traveling around the world before retirement. I hope to see different landscapes and scenery in person, experiencing exotic culture and customs.As far as I am concerned, dream is the excitement to dull life so we shall have several dreams to motivate us always moving forward.

3、 Do you think dreams have special meaning?

It's universally acknowledged that dreams are extremely meaningful to people.To be specific, dreams have special meaning. For one thing dreams work as stimulus during the process where one pursues his career or ideal life, without which people might lack motivation and easily give up.For another, dreams are what people live for. For example farmers hope to harvest and ordinary people living in the city may dream to buy a house to settle down. So it's obvious that dreams have special meaning for people.

4、 Do you want to make your dreams come true?

Making dreams come true is something that almost everyone is craving. I am not an exception.To be honest, I have several dreams, I admire interpreters who

could build up a communication bridge between people from two sides. I think it meaningful so that's my dream career. To make it come true I practice hard in reading writing and listening skills every day, by the way, I will attend an important test to get the certificate which could prove that I am qualified in theories. So in my opinion it is dream that makes me better.



14. Taking photos

1、Do you like taking selfies?

I like taking selfies. There are three reasons why I like to do so. First, I think it is very important for everyone to know how to appreciate themselves. And taking selfies is a good way to appreciate our appearance. I can gain confidence and courage from those selfies I have taken. Second, taking selfies is a means to record my journey of growth. Nowadays, with the progress of technology, it is easy for us to take selfies anytime anywhere. Wherever I go, especially at some significant occasions in my life, I usually take many selfies and these photos will become witness to my growth in the coming days. Third, taking selfies may give me the chance to become an Internet celebrity. Every time I take a selfie, I usually post it on my different social media accounts. I know I might not be the most beautiful person, but I am unique in this world. And if more and more people notice my selfies and they like those photos, they will follow my accounts. And I think the feeling of being an Internet celebrity is quite cool.

2、What is your favorite family photo?

There are many photos of me as a child, and in all of them, my favorite one is the photo in which I am wearing nothing more than basketball shorts and a tank top. It's quite funny since I kind of looked like a boy when I was young. In the photo, I stood there grinning while wearing my usual attire. I quite obviously fit into the category of a stereotypical young boy then. That's so fun. This photo reminds me that I loved being outside when I was little, so basketball shorts

were the perfect outfit, especially on hot summer days. Each time when I see the photo, I still remember when I used to wear and to do, and that's really precious.

3、 Do you like taking photos?

Yes, I do. I am quite into photography because I like recording the beautiful moments in life with my camera. Usually, I took photos with my phone because phones are easy to carry, and the photo quality is improving over the years. I used to have a DSLR camera, but I resold it because I seldom took it out with me.

4、 Do you want to improve your picture-taking skills?

Definitely yes! I am very passionate about taking great pictures of people and scenery. However, when I travel with my friends, they usually do not encourage me to take the responsibility as a photographer. I'm not sure why but I think it relates to my picture taking skills. Therefore, I need to work on this more.

15. Art

1、 Do you like drawing?

I have many hobbies among which drawing is my favorite I have been practicing drawing from an early age. The reason why I like it is that I enjoy the freedom when I focus on sketching something interesting such as cartoons in funny ways. I have fun in creating such uncommon images. I have won many awards in the past, so drawing brings me a lot of pride. Last but not the least those famous painter set great examples because they showed how to be excellent by constant efforts and hard work.

2、 Do you like to go to the gallery?

Different people have different choices for leisure. For me I like to go to the gallery in my spare time. There are several reasons why I would like to choose

a gallery as the best place to go. Firstly I have been practicing painting since I was a child. So I enjoy seeing different kinds of works from different painters. Secondly, I like to meet new friends and know interesting people in the gallery. People who share the same interest or common hobby always gather together in the gallery to appreciate the painting. So I could know new friends there who share the same interest with me. Thirdly I really enjoy set myself free during the exhibition. That's a great time when I could let my mind blank.

3、 Do you want to learn artistic things?

Of course the answer is yes I would like to learn some artistic sings such as painting, playing the piano and so forth.I remember when I was a child my mother used to take me very long distance to learn painting from a very famous teacher. Later when I grow up I found that I have gained a lot more than expected. Firstly learning such artistic thing brings me a lot of pride. Secondly fostering such a kind of hobby benefits me for I hardly spend time in playing online games or hanging around because I think it a kind of waste of time so I d rather spend time painting. I think learning artistic things is beneficial.

4、 Did you learn drawing when you were a kid?

I have learned drawing at the age of four or five years old when I was very eager for the nature and universe, I have learned to draw the interesting things on paper. I find it very meaningful. I think there are many advantages for kids to learn drawing, I member once I hung around in an exhibition where various vivid works painted by children were on show, all of which reflected their love for nature and life. It's something that even famous painters could not create. So learning drawing at an early age enables children to deepen their interest in exploring and imagining, which is quite useful in the future.

16. Cars

1、 Do you enjoy traveling by car when you were a kid?

I didn't really like traveling by car when I was a kid. Back in my childhood, the road was in terrible condition, with all the ups and downs. As a result, I always felt carsick whenever traveling by car. I remember a time when my father drove me to school, and I was sitting at the back of the car. Suddenly, I just felt sick and lay down at the backrow. I couldn't remember a single word during the class for the whole morning. It was not until lunch break that I gradually recover from that. So, traveling by car was a misery for me when I was young.

2、 What types of cars do you like?

I prefer electric vehicles to traditional fossil fuel cars. First of all, I like driving very much, and electric vehicles offer better driving experience with more responsive acceleration. Besides, it's cheaper to drive electric vehicles since electricity costs far less compared to fossil fuel. There's also cheaper service and maintenance plus low or no vehicle tax. Last but not least, electrical vehicles are environment friendly. With all the extreme weathers raging nowadays, climate change has become a pressing issue for us all. I think it's the obligation of each and every person to protect the environment. In this sense, electric cars outperform traditional ones in terms of zero carbon emission.

3、 Do you prefer to be a driver or a passenger?

I prefer to be a passenger. Driving is an exhausting task, especially during dawn and dusk when the light was dim. Drivers need to focus on the road, which is quite tiring and may harm the eyes. Besides, after a whole day of work, it's quite troublesome when you come across a terrible traffic jam when driving back home. You have lost all your patience and energy at workplace, but you still need to cope with the hustle and bustle, endure the annoying horn and maybe sacrifice the whole evening if there occurred an accident. As a result, I prefer to be a passenger, so that I can have a rest at the backrow and even take a

short sleep before arriving at the destination.

4、What do you usually do when there is a traffic jam?

I'll search for shortcuts when there's a traffic jam in front of my car. As more people are using the GPS nowadays, sometimes the app will guide everyone onto the same road. As a result, a traffic jam took place. However, there're alternatives that can bring you to the same place. Since I'm pretty familiar with the road system, I will look for other routes. But if I'm already in the middle of the traffic jam, then I will just wait patiently and keep alert to other cars who might have the intention to cut in the queue.

17. The area you live in

1、Where do you like to go in that area?

The city library is where I frequently visit in the place I live, because I prefer a tranquil atmosphere and people in the library are always silent. So, even if I don't want to read, going to the library to work/study is also what I would do. Besides, there are many activities held by the library regularly, which I may find meaningful to participate in.

2、Do you know any famous people in your area?

I remember that some popular singers in China come from where I live now, who have won several singing competitions, and produced songs which enjoy great popularity. And in ancient times, this land also cultivated a large number of productive poets who made a valuable contribution to the development of Chinese poetry.

3、What are some changes in the area recently?

According to my observation, the biggest change that took place here is that there are more and more entertaining venues now. People here have come up with a variety of stuff to relax recently, so accordingly, a lot more related

facilities have been constructed. And another difference is that, the public transport system is far more completed, with more metro lines being built.

4 、 Do you like the area that you live in?

Honestly speaking, not very much. Although I can see how much this area has developed, I am still not very satisfied with the current situation. One reason is that, I suppose this place is so overpopulated, so commuting is really a torture for me every day. Meanwhile, the air quality here is also terrible, and I am afraid that I will get some lung diseases one day if I keep living here.

18. Hometown

1、 What's (the name of) your hometown (again)?

My hometown is Chengdu, the capital city of Sichuan Province.

2、 Please describe your hometown a little.

It is located in southwest China. It is the capital of Sichuan province and metropolis of southeast China. It is a big city with a convenient traffic system. The surrounding Chengdu Plain is also known as the "Country of Heaven" and the "Land of Abundance". I am very proud of my hometown.

3、 Is that a big city or a small place?

Chengdu is a big city. I think it is the biggest city in southwest China. Moreover, it is a fast-developing city. What's fascinating about Chengdu is that it is not only a comfortable city for senior citizens to enjoy their old ages, but also a city with a lot of opportunities where young people can work hard and fulfill their dreams.

4、 How long have you lived there?

I've lived here for 18 years. I left for Beijing when I went to college. It's quite challenging for me to get out of my comfort zone. However, I made it.

19. Home/Accommodation

1、Do you live in a house or a flat?

Well, I live in a house with my family in suburb areas. Far away from city center as it is, we own 3 spacious rooms, a beautiful balcony and a garden where we can have barbecue almost all-year around. Although the living infrastructure nearby is still under construction, it is still worthwhile to live here.

2、Do you prefer living in a house or a flat?

I prefer living in a house. I think house is better than flat. Firstly, many houses have a backyard where the pet can live and play. Also, you can have a garden in the backyard, and plant some flowers to decorate your house.

3、Can you describe the place where you live?

I live in a comfortable and cozy flat. It is a duplex apartment. I live on the 21st floor. From the window of my bedroom, I can overlook the garden in the housing estate. It is not very big, but I still have enough space.

4、Who do you live with?

I live with my cat Max. I thought I might feel lonely if I live alone, so I decided to have Max. It proved to be a very good decision. Max is a gray British Shorthair and I love him so much. Even though my cat can't speak, he is constantly trying to find ways to communicate with me. Every time I get home, he greets me with a passionate "meow".

20. Work or study

1、What subjects are you studying?

I study English literature.

2、Do you like your subject?

Of course. I think it is my love towards this subject that keeps me continuing my study. Studying English actually broadens my horizon. Learning English helps me to enhance my knowledge of every field over the world through reading English documents which are not only in books, newspapers but also on the internet.

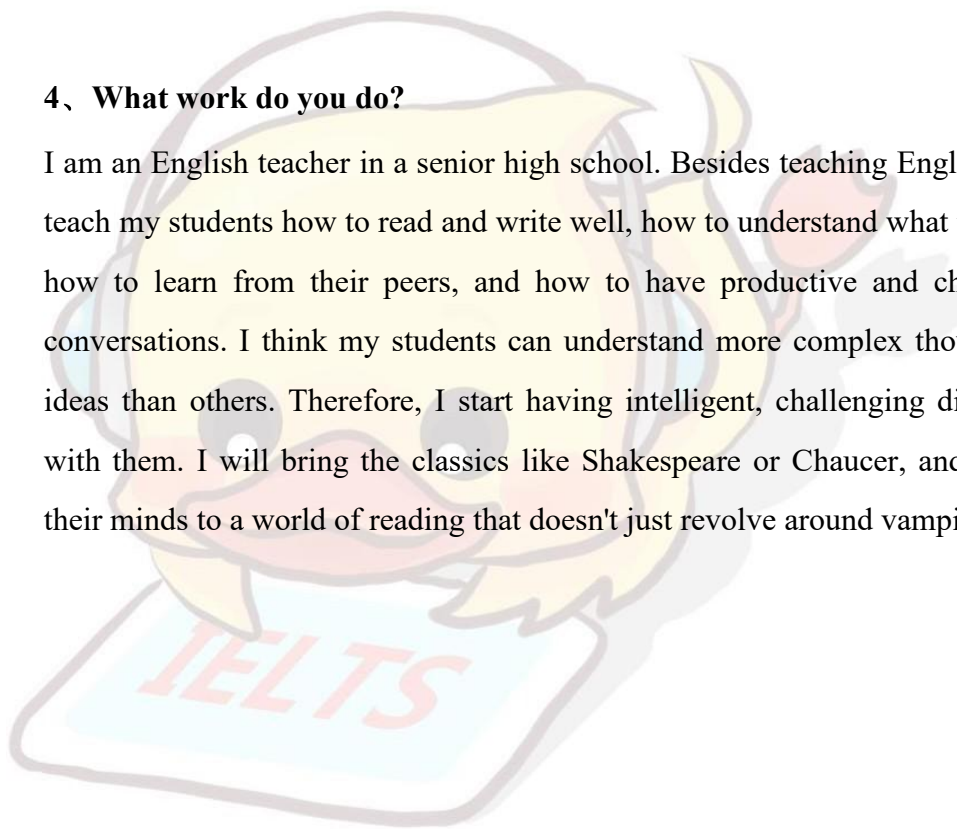


3、Is it interesting?

I think so. First of all, studying English literature means that you can not only learn a language but also get to know a culture. Moreover, it gives me a chance to read a lot of great books. I will never pick up some of the books if they hadn't been on the syllabus. Whilst the occasional book or style of writing may not resonate with you, it's really interesting and important to read books out of the box.

4、What work do you do?

I am an English teacher in a senior high school. Besides teaching English, I also teach my students how to read and write well, how to understand what they read, how to learn from their peers, and how to have productive and challenging conversations. I think my students can understand more complex thoughts and ideas than others. Therefore, I start having intelligent, challenging discussions with them. I will bring the classics like Shakespeare or Chaucer, and open up their minds to a world of reading that doesn't just revolve around vampire books.



P2&P3 新题

1. 保健方式

Describe something you do to keep fit and healthy

You should say:

What it is

When you do it

Who you do it with

And explain why you think this method is important



Well, talking about a **wholesome**(健康的 **healthy**) activity, I know a bunch of healthy ones I would want to share with you, but the one I would like to introduce the most now is quite special to me. This activity is morning jogging (晨跑 **morning running**)

You know there is a traditional proverb in China, saying **an hour in the morning is worth two in the evening** (一天之计在于晨). Therefore, you can see how important mornings are to the Chinese people.

I joined a jogging club 2 years ago, and they often organize morning activities. I get up quite early, approximately 6 o'clock and I always join the club organized activity to jog in the nearby park. We all enjoy the soft breeze on our faces. When we feel a little bit tired, we stop to have a breakfast sold by the **roadside vendors**(路边摊). Frankly speaking (坦白来说 **to be candid**), I used to be a **homebody**(宅男), you know, I was just **glued to the** (喜欢) TV and the computer every day. However, after suffering from heavy **pneumonia** (肺炎), I realized that it was important to boost my physical health and jogging was the best way to achieve just that. As for the frequency, to jog every 2 days is suitable for me. When I feel a little bit **idle** (懒惰的 **lazy**), I always remind myself that I should persist on.

I really enjoy jogging and I believe it is quite beneficial. In fact, jogging makes me feel youthful and it teaches me to be positive when facing difficulties.

In a nutshell, I think this activity is worth recommending.

Part 3

1) How do children and old people keep fit and healthy?

As is often the case that children and old people are more vulnerable to most diseases, especially after outbreak of COVID-19, keeping fit has seemed to be attached more importance than ever. But due to many reasons, children and old people are taking different measures to keep fit and healthy. For children, it's quite common to see them run, jog, swim and so forth. For old people, it might be difficult for them to take up such sports events, they are more likely to choose such aerobic exercise as walking and square dancing. Anyway, it makes sense as long as people are moving.

2) What do people normally do to keep fit and healthy in your country?

In my country, people of different ages do various sports events to keep fit and healthy. For the old, they prefer walking and square dancing, a small part of them also choose to do Tai Chi Quan to obtain both health in condition and gentleness in mind. But for adults, the ways they take exercise are diverse such as going to the gym and following professional instructors, jogging and doing some particular aerobics like Pamela and Zumba. But for children, they take PE lessons to go swimming, jumping, running and so on. In my point of view, no matter what kind of manner you choose to keep fit, always keep safety in mind.

2. 重要河流/湖泊

Describe an important river/lake in your country

You should say:

Where it is located

How big/long it is

What it looks like

And explain why it is important

I'm gonna talk about the Yangtze River, which is of paramount importance(十分重要) to China.

When I was a little child, I was very interested in the colorful pictures of

encyclopedia (百科全书) for kids and there were many articles and pictures about Yangtze river. Therefore, this river left me a strong impression. However, it was in the geography class that (it isthat..强调句) I really learned a lot about this river.

It is said the Yangtze river is the third longest river across the globe (全世界) and the longest river in Asia. The length of it is about 6,200 kilometers which is quite impressive.

It is of great importance to China in several perspectives.(方面) Firstly, it is conducive (有利的) to our country's agricultural industry because this river is a natural irrigation system to surrounding cities. Secondly, it is also a natural transportation system which boosts southern China's economy, especially cities in Yangtze river delta like Shanghai. Last but not the least, it is the cradle of Chinese civilization. We all take pride in it. If I have an opportunity, I will travel there by myself taking a lot of pictures and post those pictures on sina weibo and Facebook because I want Chinese netizens as well as those from other countries to share the splendid beauty of Yangtze River.

Part 3

1) How can rivers/lakes benefit local people?

It's known to us that almost every primitive civilization was derived from river coasts, the main reason is that water is the most important factor in our life. First of all, rivers benefit local agriculture which is a huge part of local economy in most countries in the world, as liquid water provides rich and fertile soil. Secondly, rivers make it more convenient to develop trade and business. Thirdly, rivers bring local people milder and cozier climate. But on the other hand, rivers also mean higher risks of flood. So it's important to protect rivers and lakes.

2) Do you think rivers/lakes attract tourists?

Well, take China as an example, I think it's a very open question, because people have different interests in traveling, some like the endless grassland in the

northwest, while some others prefer going to the region of rivers and lakes. But as far as I'm concerned, rivers and lakes do attract most tourists because there are more diversified activities and events, for example, tourists like boating on the river, feeling the nature coming alongside. Swimming and drifting are also widely popular these years. So more people are willing to go to coastal areas to spend their holiday.



3. 庆祝过的活动

Describe an important event you celebrated

You should say:

What the event was

When it happened

Who attended the event

And explain how you feel about the event

I'd like to talk about my dad's 50-year-old birthday party. You see, in China, we reckon that there are several birthdays which outstands(超过) the rest, cuz they carry kind of a cultural meaning. (宾语/定语/原因复合从句) Or let's say they serve the function of milestones which marks a new, different stage of your life. For the 50th birthday, we Chinese believe people can understand the destiny(知天命), or maybe predict the future. A bit superstitious, I'd say, but I guess one just become wiser after turning 50. Also, from my old man's perspective, he said, and I quote, that one can literally feel the ruthless power of age(岁月的无情力量) after his 50th birthday.

Anyway, I was already doing my internship in a local company, so I saved some money for this special day. I called a very fine restaurant near my home, and made reservation for a private room. My old man fancies traditional Chinese spirit, so I also prepared a famous Maotai for him, you know, I think he deserves the very best. Of course, I told no one about this, not even my mum. When it came to his birthday and my mum asked me to find somewhere we could dine out, I told her that everything had been arranged.

Everything went well that day, and my plan was almost perfect. Well, almost, cuz my old man got a bit drunk and overly talkative(酒醉话多) ha-ha! I swear I saw tears in his eyes, which I've never seen in the past 22 years. I guess he's just proud of me.

Part 3



1) Do you like to celebrate important events? Why?

There is a famous saying nowadays that it's important to have a sense of ceremony in life. I agree with that idea because I interpret the sense of ceremony in life as living with passion. It doesn't mean to spend much time and money to celebrate such important events as anniversaries and birthdays, it actually means to make some particular days different from other ordinary ones. I think behind this thought is the real demand of spirit, life is so quick in modern society while those ceremonies seem especially treasured. All in all, I support people to celebrate some important events to treat the special thing with passion, but people should also learn to keep things under the principle of loose and tight.

2) What kinds of events do people usually celebrate?

As far as I'm concerned, most people celebrate such important events as wedding anniversary, birthday, valentine's day, Mother's day and so forth. I think such celebrations represent ones' attitude and passion because celebrating with lovers or families enables people to remember some old days and thus learn to be grateful. But as you may know, more and more people are driven by some multifarious promotions on social media, as a result, people are pursuing celebrations almost every month, I think it becomes a kind of waste. So people should really keep calm in this kind of celebration.

4. 感兴趣的邻居

Describe an interesting neighbor

You should say:

Who he/she is

How you knew him/her

What you do together

And explain why he/she is interesting

The interesting neighbor I'd like to talk about is quite a celebrity(明星) in our community(小区) whom we usually call Aunt Xu, which is a quite common title(称谓) here in China when people want to show their respect to elders by not directly calling them by their name. Now she is retired, but she used to be a teacher in a dance studio that was owned by the local government.

The first time I met her was in the spring of last year, as I was walking around the nearby square after dinner. I saw her and other elders dancing with big smiles on their faces. It was nothing like what I was used to seeing. You know, a bunch of elderly retired ladies doing some simple synchronized moves(同步的动作) with loud music. Quite the opposite, her moves were quite professional and elegant. Through her dance, you could tell that she had a passion for it. Since then, I've become one of her fans who love to see her dance.

The interesting thing about her is that she doesn't like to talk too much. Instead, she likes to dance and she never misses her scheduled(日程) dance, every day in the park.

Over the past few years, I have noticed that her dance partners kept changing. I found out later, that all the previous ones found it hard to keep up with her level of dancing skills. So sometimes she enjoys dancing alone, with only the company of the soothing music (在舒缓音乐的陪伴下). I wish I could be like her, finding something that I like and am passionate about it.

Part 3

1) Do you think people are familiar with their neighbors?

In terms of neighborhood relationships, the outbreak of COVID-19 really brought big changes to our country. Take myself as a typical example, in the past, I hardly knew my neighbors because we all hurried to work every day. But since the last quarantine period at home, I got to know how it was true to say

better good neighbour near than relatives far away. My neighbors were all very kind-hearted people, we used to comfort each other and provide timely needs to those who lacked food or medicine. Although there are many people still being unfamiliar with neighbors, I would say that it's great to break the ice and make more friends, let alone your neighbors.

2) How can people improve the relationship with neighbors in a community?

Speaking of this question, I couldn't help thinking of the first lesson on how to make new friends. I believe improving relationships is exactly the same way as making good friends. The first step is to break the ice, which means to be active to talk whenever you meet your neighbors. The next step is to deepen the relationship between the two sides, why not ask your neighbors to go outing on holidays, have a picnic or just wash cars together, it all makes sense. Besides the above two steps, I think the core value is that one should be ready to offer help at any time to neighbors.

5. 花费甚少的外出日

Describe a special day out that cost you little money/didn't cost you much

You should say:

When was the day

Where you went

How much you spent

And explain how you feel about the day

Well, special days are very important in everyone's life. In our country, it's really common that people spend a lot on their special days like birthdays, marriages, or some get-together with friends. If on such occasion one doesn't have to spare a fortune, then it will make the day extra special.

I would like to talk about one such special day several months ago, when I reunited with my old friends at a newly opened restaurant in our town.

I saw good reviews online about this restaurant, and the pictures looked really attractive. It's a café named Bones & Slaw. According to the reviews online, the

cost per person would be around 500 RMB. I know it's everything but inexpensive, but please hear me out.

We reached there around 8pm. As soon as we entered the café, we were astonished by the interiors. The furniture was very trendy and there was beautiful lighting creating a vibe. We ordered some starters and mains which were also named after famous songs. The food was really delicious, and we enjoyed it with the music.

The biggest surprise came when I asked for the bill, cuz the waiter said we didn't need to pay at all. First, I thought it was a mistake but later the manager told us that we were their 100th customer, so whatever we ordered was on the house.

I felt really overjoyed on hearing this, pretty like winning a lottery. But I guess such thing won't happen often cuz it's pure luck.

Part 3

1) Do people like to spend their leisure time out in your country?

Honestly speaking, I think it's no longer a matter of preference now in China, because of the COVID situation. Every time there are some new cases, the community or even the whole city would be in lockdown. People cannot even step out of their homes, let alone go out for leisure activities. I have seen some videos online and people are working at home, cooking at home, doing sports at home, or even shooting a film at home. I think quarantine is driving people nuts. I really miss those days when we could go out and enjoy our life freely. Hopefully, COVID could vanish forever.

2) How do people spend their leisure time in China?

If you're looking for a unified answer, the majority of Chinese tend to spend their leisure time with their family. But in fact, it varies among different groups. For many youngsters, sitting before their computers or cellphones is the way they do. They can do a lot of things on those screens, like playing computer games, watching films or TV shows, chatting with friends, or just browsing

websites without any purpose. Some young people are fans of traveling, either at home or abroad. For the middle ages, the answer might be drinking; for the old, the answer might be dancing.

I guess what Chinese do in leisure time has little difference from people in other countries. Because it all depends and there is no fixed answer.



6. 想参加的比赛

Describe a contest/competition you would like to participate in

You should say:

What the contest/competition is about

Where the contest/competition will take place

When it will be held

And explain why you would like to participate in it

A competition I would like to take part in is the annual football league(年度足球联赛). It is a series of games (系列赛) between our school and other schools in my city. This was a highly anticipated (高度参与) game because there are lots of gossip talking among most schools in terms of who has a better football team.

The football league is actually four matches that held in different high schools and it's our turn this year, all the matches will be held in the sport stadium at our school. The stadium is newly built with very contemporary looking(现代化的外观).

It was No.3 middle school that won the champion last year, i still remember the stadium was packed with people (挤满了人) on the day of the match, there were many people from different schools and everyone wore their school's uniform. It was pretty exciting, when one team scored, the crowd cheered and it felt like a world cup game (世界杯比赛) .

Personally, I'm a big fan of football and the match was still very enjoyable for

me because both players and audiences got highly involved in the matches. It was a wonderful feeling. I think that's the thing about sports, you don't have to be a fan or a player to enjoy a good sports event.

Part 3

1) What are the contests commonly seen on TV programs?

The most common contests displayed on TV programs might be sports-related ones like football, basketball, ping-pong, swimming and so much forth. Contest programs always stand for audiences' interests and hobbies, the reason why sports contests are common to be seen is that the industry itself needs fierce competition to get audiences involved. Another popular contest program is the art show, which has gained a wide range of popularity these years like the Voice of China and some other idol development programs. But all in all, contest programs should show the true spirit of competition instead of reshaping the good tradition in a country.

2) What kinds of industries need competition? Why?

Generally speaking, most industries face competition in modern society, but to be more specific, I'd like to discuss some very typical ones that need competition. It's obvious that sports industry is one where competition takes place at almost every corner, the main reason for which is that sports events are all about win or lose games that take two sides to fight for the gold medal. I think the result not only represents victory, but also, more importantly, shows participants' perseverance, grit and hard work. That's the true spirit of sports and the core value of competition itself.

7. 丢东西的经历

Describe an occasion that you lost something

You should say:

What you lost

When and where you lost it

What you did to find it

And explain how you felt about it

Frankly speaking, I lost many things accidentally in the past few years and even my mother once blamed me for being so careless. When talking about the most significant thing that I lost before, I would name one notebook which basically recorded everything happened around me when I was a freshman (大学一年级新生). That is my diary.



Keeping a diary has been regarded as a good habit since my Chinese teacher in high school constantly tells us that if we spare ten minutes every day to write down the funny thing we've encountered (遭遇), we can memorize our fruitful life when growing up. So as for me, that diary offers me a chance to escape from the reality and portray (描绘) my own fantasy. Also, I share my secrets completely with it without worrying that it would criticize my decisions. For example, once I signed for (注册报名) a speech competition, but I was too timid to speak loudly in front of all the judges and students, so I was determined to quit the contest. I knew that if I talked to my parents, they would treat me like a coward, so I turned to my diary.

Unfortunately, during my trip in Japan, I left my diary in one Airbnb house I've rented in Tokyo, and I didn't even notice that it was lost until that night when I try to record things down. Obviously, it was not feasible for me to get that diary back since I had already arrived in Osaka. I contacted the landlord immediately and got a quick response. Chinese travelers who rented his house after I left agreed to mail my diary to me once they came back to China. I cannot show more gratitude to their hospitality (乐于助人). Lucky for me, to get something I've cherished back!

Part 3

1) What kinds of things do people usually lose?

To be honest, I have been so good at losing things, I used to lose my computer and some small items such as keys. A survey shows that below items are often

lost by people, the number one is, of course, key, because it's too small and unnoticeable, I have lost my keys at least three times. The second one comes the wallet, but fortunately enough, as the cash free society develops, not many people bring their wallets all the time. In a word, it's quite common to lose something, the best way to avoid that is to have those important things well-kept.



2) What do people often do when losing things?

Typically people often take the following several steps after losing things. First, it's necessary to make sure how important it is, for example, when people lose their mobile phones, they should call the services and banks to freeze their accounts so that nobody would steal their money or take social accounts for illegal use. Second, it's wise to think up ideas to find them back, if some important items are lost, people often call the police to find them back. Last but not least, don't be anxious, keep calm and find solutions.

8. 安静的地方

Describe a quiet place

You should say:

Where it is

How you knew it

How often you go there

What you do there

And explain how you feel about the place

There is a coffee house in our community. To be more specific, it's just downstairs the place where I live. It's a quiet and peaceful place, which is extremely suitable for people who enjoy the slow pace life(慢节奏生活), like me.

When I have nothing special to do in the afternoon, I often visit it. I will just buy one cup of coffee. By the way, it's free to refill your cup, and casually browse(随意翻阅) the magazines and newspapers on the bookshelves. Readers have access to all kinds of novels, essays or even poems. The owner of this coffee house is really friendly to customers. People are free to(自由) stay here as

long as they want to. I don't know too much about him, but I am sure he is an idealist.

There are always 6 or 7 people here in the afternoon with nobody making any noise. Everyone deals with their work or reads quietly without disturbing others. And normally, this place would play some slow and gentle music while we are reading, which makes everything look even better. I have spent countless afternoons there and I regard it as the ideal place to idle away time(打发时间).

Part 3

1) Is it easy to find quiet places in your country? Why?

I think it depends, if you want to find quiet places in large cities, it's not an easy task because there are large populations in cities, making most places in cities crowded. But if people prefer places in suburban areas, it's not difficult to find many quiet places. For life-long living, rural areas are quiet, but if you would like to escape from the city for a while, then you could refer to some rural hotels to make yourself relieved.

2) Why do old people prefer to live in quiet places?

Well, I suppose the main reason could be that when living in quiet places, people have more space to set themselves free from bustle and hustle. Especially for the old, peace and freedom are extremely desirable which could only be found in quiet places. The second reason is that old people could live in a very simple way in quiet places because it takes them less time to line up and wait, enabling them to spend more time relaxing and thinking, quiet places also provide old people with better sleep and fresher air.

9. 让你惊讶的事情

Describe something that surprised you

You should say:

What it is

How you found out about it

What you did

And explain whether it made you happy

I am now an enthusiastic fan of sports, while several years ago, staying at home and playing computer games were my favorite. I was totally changed in a summer holiday. One day, I realized that my recent life was **totally a drag** (无聊, 累赘) and **it was high time** (是时候了) to **turn the tide** (改变).

Then I invited my uncle, to be specific, a professional basketball player to **impart** some basketball skills **to** (传授) me and helped me take up a new hobby. However, I was super **stunned** (惊讶) by his training content. Instead of practicing basketball skills including **shooting or dribbling** (投篮和运球), his first lesson to me was 10-kilometer running, which was almost impossible for me to fulfill. At that moment, I felt that I **even saw the light from the heaven**. (快晕倒了)

While, at the same time, my uncle encouraged me to challenge myself as **perseverance** (坚持) and courage are the key to success, especially in basketball. I listened to him and insisted to achieve his goal. At the end of the day I was **dead beat** (累坏了) but super satisfied with what I had achieved. After that day, basketball and sports became a **pivotal constituent** (重要组成部分) of my daily life as what sports can bring to me is not only the energy but the **optimistic attitude** (积极乐观的态度) towards everything in my life.

Part 3

1) How do people express happiness in your culture?

Compared with most of western cultures, the essence of our Chinese culture is courtesy. Though people hug each other when feeling over the moon, it is not that common. As a country with a long history of colorful arts, dancing is one of the most preferable ways for Chinese people to celebrate, especially during a variety of festivals and anniversaries. In Chinese New Year, what is the most famous is the lion dance as the lion has been long regarded by ancient people as the symbol of luck. Nowadays, people dressed as lions and dancing along the drumbeat are pervasive everywhere in China to share happiness.

1) Do you think happiness has any effect on people? How?

Yes, I am unequivocal that happiness has an overridingly positive effect on people. With the feeling of happiness, it is more possible for people to hold a more optimistic attitude towards everything in their lives. Without happiness, people tend to be seriously plagued by anxiety and depression which will have a malignant effect not only on their working efficiency but also on their physical and mental condition as abundance of evidence has been cited by numerous experts to demonstrate that pessimistic emotion can breed chronic kidney's and brain's illness.

10. 未来想一起共事的家人

Describe a family member who you want to work with in the future

You should say:

Who he/she is

Whether you worked together before?

What kind of work you would like to do with him/her

And explain how you feel about this family member

Well, among my family members, the person I would like to work with is my brother David. David is my senior by 3 years and is one of the most brilliant people I have ever met. He is now working in a big architect firm where he designs modern houses and buildings.

Certainly, I have worked with him before, though that was not something major, only some small projects. He and I participated in a Lego construction competition held by the elementary school I went to. What I learned from him is that determination brings success. We failed several times before we finally built the model as intended. At times when I got upset David was the one who never stopped trying.

I hope to work with him in the field of architectural design someday. I might not be an expert, but David is definitely an ideal partner.

That leads to how I feel about him. As an individual, he is gifted and diligent,

and I believe he'd become a great architect sooner or later. He has so many interests and hobbies that I sometimes wonder how a single person could be so skilled and well-informed in so many areas. Mathematics, physics, sports, history, literature... you name it, and he has it. He is also charismatic and never loses his temper, which makes him a very pleasant colleague. When we worked together previously, no matter how inexperienced I was, he always guided me in the right direction. That's why I believe to be a fellow worker of him would be an amazing experience.

Part 3

1) What kinds of family business are common in China?

I don't really know much about the business world, so I'm just gonna blurt out whatever comes to my mind. Personally, I know two types of family corporations. One is the handcraft workshop type. For example, the father is a shoemaker, so is his son, and so is his grandson. Something like that. This type of business is usually small-scaled and passed down for generations. The other type is more modern, such as those private enterprises whose stakeholders are all from the same family. Not necessarily every member participates in the company's operation, but if the business is doing well, a bunch of people get shares.

2) Is it good to work with family members? Why?

I would say it's quite risky. Colleagues and relatives are supposed to be two different social relationships, and messing them up would make things complicated. I mean, if it's pure colleague when things go wrong, we can turn to the law or go to arbitration without hesitation. But imagine when a family business is falling apart and you're fighting with your uncle or cousin, it's really difficult for everyone to stay objective and put emotions aside.

With that being said, one good thing about working with family is the kinship. You don't need to familiarize yourself with colleagues from scratch, because

you know them well already.

11. 帮助集中注意力的方法

Describe something you do that can help you concentrate on work/study

You should say:

What it is

How it helps you concentrate

When you do it

And explain how you feel about it



Well I think the only thing that can keep me concentrated is to keep my mobile phone away – or better still, to shut it down. You know how those smart devices lure and enslave us nowadays. (宾语从句，两个精确词汇，引诱和奴役)

Total abyss I'd say. There are so much fun in them, like social networks, you know, weibo and douyin and such and such, or those RSS apps like quora and zhihu. It's really hard to keep your eyes and hands off it if it's within your touch(在能拿到的地方), and you can easily waste – alright, spend – hours on those stuff.

Now, when I decide to do something serious, like my dissertation or intern job, I just mute my phone and put it in another room. The method is, so far, quite effective to me. I believe my efficiency triples as I get rid of my mobile. Like, there was a time before I applied this method, and actually I think I spent a whole day on a really simple report I had to finish, barely before the deadline(勉强赶上截止时间). I guess this really makes you think what technology can bring us. Convenience? Yes, but that's not the whole picture. With convenience comes um... shall I say enchantment?(倒装句，精确词汇，魔咒) People become puppets, and the strings are the Internet. The problem is that these smart devices are more than a hex, they are drugs! Even if we know the cons they lead to, we still can't really live without them. We say a coin always has two sides(恰当使用谚语), perhaps this is a perfect example of the proverb.

Part 3

1) Why is it more difficult for children to concentrate nowadays than in the past?

I think it is not good news for children but indeed more importance should be attached to this problem. The deep reason could be that there are more distractions today than in the past, for example, decades ago when smart phones and internet were not prevalent, children only focused on what they were doing. But nowadays, almost every child has easy access to the Internet, they are more likely to be distracted from schoolwork or other things. Such change is unnoticeable so I do hope parents should be alert to this problem and try to keep children concentrated.

2) Do you think technology will harm children's ability to concentrate?

To make it clear, it's not technology that harms children's ability to concentrate, but fragmented information produced by technology does so. With the fast pace of life, it's easy to wonder adults are more likely to look through information that is sorted by social media, let alone children. If children are always fed with such information cocoons, their abilities to think independently and to concentrate are sure to be damaged. To avoid this problem, parents should accompany children to get away from smart tools and go back to paper books.

12. 传统产品

Describe a traditional product in your country

You should say:

What it is

When you tried this product for the first time

What it is made of

And explain how you feel about it

The traditional product I'd like to talk about is tea. It's got thousands of years' history.

I was born in a tea-lovers' family, so I tried it at a very young age, 5 or 6, I suppose. I only have a faint memory (模糊的记忆) that the first time I drank

it, I didn't like it, cuz it was too bitter (苦).

I guess I began to like drinking tea when I went to high school. You know, as a high school student, I had to do loads of assignments (作业). Sometimes I even worked overnight, so I needed some stimulants (让人兴奋的东西) to keep me awake (让我保持清醒). Coffee was too strong for me, while (而) tea was an ideal choice. The more I drank it, the more I knew about it.

Actually, there are various types of tea that are planted across China. The most amazing fact is that they all taste different. Green tea might be bitter at the first sip (抿, 喝一次小口), but later you'll feel its refreshing aftertaste (余味). So people usually drink it in summer. Black tea is not bitter but rich in flavor. It warms your stomach. There are also many kinds of scented tea (花茶) made of flowers. Famous ones are camomile (甘菊), jasmine (茉莉) and rose buds (玫瑰花蕾).

Tea making can be very complex. Different types of tea require different water temperatures. First, you put some tea leaves into a pot and wash them with hot boiled water (热开水). Then, water is added again and distributed (分发, 分配) into small tea cups for the guests to drink. I enjoy the process of tea making, it's slow and peaceful.

Part3

1) Why are traditional products important?

The reasons are as follows, firstly traditional products are the wisdom of many generations, people today could just benefit from them. Take Chinese tea as an example, at present, Asian countries produce over 90 percent of world's output. Secondly, traditional products have unique historic meanings, each one represents the level of development in a certain period of time. So it's as important to protect those traditional products as to create new ones.

2) Do you think tradition is important for a country? Why?

The answer is, of course, yes. Tradition is very important for a country. It's because tradition tells people what the old generations were doing, so that people could learn some useful things from the past. Just as an old saying goes that only when you know where you were from, will you know clearly the direction where you are heading for. I think it's exactly the reason why tradition is so important for a country. In China, children learn basic rules and morality from an early age, that's how tradition influences people today.

13. 帮助小孩

Describe a time when you helped a child

You should say:

When it was

How you helped him/her

Why you helped him/her

And how you felt about it

When I was in college, I helped a child who was also my relative. It was in my freshman year (大一的时候), all my family members knew that I majored in English, and they thought I mastered language learning. Some would ask me to do them a favor (帮他们一个忙) and tutor their children in English.

In fact, my aunt asked me to practice oral English with her daughter. That little girl was in the third grade of elementary school yet already mastered more than 1,000 English words. She could do simple English conversations. I went to her home every day during the summer vacation, practicing with her for an hour each time. I chose a topic for the conversation every day, such as traveling or her favorite singer. After that, I gave her a list of English words and expressions to expand her vocabulary.

I really enjoyed that period of time, because the girl was very smart and hardworking. She would memorize the list I gave her every time I left her home. No wonder (怪不得) she had known so many new words in her primary school.

After tutoring, my aunt bought me a new iPad as a reward. I felt extremely happy and had a sense of accomplishment (成就感) because I could both help my loved ones and get gifts.

Part 3

1) Do you often help kids? How?

I used to major in the theory of education during college because I have been keen on education. Now I still keep helping kids learn English and make friends. I mainly help them by working as a volunteer, I take part in the voluntary program in the community to teach kids English at weekends, I set up an English Corner in the community where kids could share some funny stories or just say something very simple. It's satisfying to see their improvements. I swear I would stick to this program in the future.

2) Why is it necessary to do volunteer services?

It's not rare to see many adults take part in volunteer services, I think it remarkable because voluntary work is necessary for both community and individual. For the community, volunteers have shouldered many tasks and helped reduce the financial burden. For volunteers themselves, such work would help cultivate their sense of responsibility, which is a very treasured morality in both life and work. So in a word, people should be encouraged to do volunteer services.

14. 积极的改变

Describe a positive change that you made in your life

You should say:

What the change was

Why you did it

Who you did it with

And explain how you feel about the change

When it comes to a positive change I have made, I would like to talk about an important change that I made about my character.

I was quite a careless person (一个非常粗心的人) since I was young. When I

was a kid, my parents were always around to help me make up for (弥补) my mistakes. For example, they would buy a new bus pass (公交卡) for me when I lost mine. Thus, I never realized that my carelessness was a serious problem.

This changed last year when I did the part time job in a convenient store (便利店). One morning, I was working as a cashier (收银员) in the shop. A customer bought some snacks for about 90 yuan. He gave me a hundred because he didn't have change (零钱). While I was supposed to return him 10 yuan, I returned him 90 without calculating carefully. When I realized my mistake, it was already dark outside. The manager scolded me furiously (暴怒地) and asked me to pay for the loss if the customer didn't come back to return the extra money. If I didn't do so, he would fire me instantly. In the end, I had to use my allowance (零花钱) to cover my mistake and ate instant noodles at noon for a whole month.

After that, I become careful about everything in my life, especially for things related to figures. I have never made any mistake about calculation in both my studies and my work. Sometimes, life is the best teacher (生活是最好的老师).

Part 3

1) Is it easy for old people to change?

From my point of view, it is undeniable that people are likely to change frequently in today's fast pace society while it is almost impossible for the elderly. First, compared with the young generation, with the vulnerable age, the elder generation is not that mentally agile and energetic. Inundated with an abundance of information, valuable or not, most old people claim that dealing with it almost drives them mad and exhausted every day. Second, as the elderly are accustomed to the role they are used to playing as an experienced consultant, the self-esteem of them is much stronger, which to some extent leads to their stubbornness.

2) How can people change their daily routine if they want to?

As to the method to change, different people may have their own ideas while I am firmly convinced that advanced technology could be the panacea. Thanks to the introduction of mobile phones, nowadays people can exchange information with colleagues within seconds, which is a feat that can't be achieved by our ancestors. As a result, the immediate access to work can lead to the disappearance of the traditional 5-day work so that parents who attach great importance to their kids can design a more flexible timetable and regularly change their daily routine to spend more time with their children to ensure their intellectual and emotional development.

15. 改变世界的发明

Describe an invention that has changed the world in a positive way

You should say:

What it is

What benefits it has brought

How it influences people of different ages

And explain how it changed people's lives

In my opinion (在我看来), the invention that has changed the world would be printer.

I am sure almost everyone knows what a printer (打印机) is. It is a device that can be used with a computer. You just need to click a button on the computer, and then the printer would print out what's on the screen of the computer. I think it has changed the world in a great deal. For example, I don't think newspaper industry was that popular when there was no printer. With printers, whenever you want to show something to someone, you just need to print it out and it only takes several seconds to do so. Also with newspaper, people get to know about current issues in a super short time. It helps information to circulate (流通) pretty fast.

I think it is popular in almost every age. For example, people like me, a student, would need it to print out my train tickets or schoolwork. People who work would need it to print out documents. Most old people have a habit of reading

news and printers are essential for (对..很重要) the production of it.

I think it is an amazing invention. It makes our life more convenient in a great deal. I am so glad that we have it in our lives. Without it, I would have no idea how to bring the contents on my word documents to school. And I think if there's no printer, I would have to stare at the computer almost all the time, which would do great damage to my eyes.

Part 3

1) What is the most helpful innovation at home?

Dishwasher. I'm not a lazy person, but I don't like doing housework cuz it's time-consuming and non-productive – you can't really call finishing the housework a big achievement, right? So I think the dishwasher is a life-saver and THE most helpful innovation at home. It usually takes one and a half hours to clean the desk and dishes after meal every day. But after using the dishwasher, it only takes 20 mins and that means a lot to me. Because not only I can free myself from plain labor, but I also save time to do more meaningful and important things, such as talking with my family, doing exercises and taking my dog for a walk.

2) What household appliances make us lazy?

Television, I think. We have so many developed household appliances coming up these days – washing machines, dishwashers, microwaves, etc. But these appliances are to free us from time-consuming and non-productive housework, which grant us more time to do meaningful things, like talking with our family, doing exercises or taking walks with our pets. However, TV seems to be an appliance just to kill time. We can just be a couch potato and don't think or don't do anything else. By spending too much time watching TV, we may lose the time to read a good book or to do some interesting and meaningful with people that really matter in our life. So, in my point of view, TV makes people not only lazy in body but also in mind.

16. 受欢迎的名人

Describe a popular well-known person in your country

You should say:

Who this person is

What he/she has done

Why he/she is popular

And explain how you feel about this person



I'd like to tell you about Zhang Ji ke, a well-known Chinese table tennis player. He's in his late 20's (接近30岁) now, but I think he was selected to be trained for the national team (国家队) when he was only about 12. So basically he devoted all his youth to the table tennis career, a really consistant and persistent sport professional. (是个非常有毅力的职业运动员)

Well, I knew about him when he won a gold medal for China in the London Olympic game six years ago. Later on, I noticed that he's a familiar face on the sports channel on TV. I'm always fascinated by his skillful techniques. I mean, this guy obviously knows what he's doing (他真的非常擅长这项运动). Like any star would shine, his name started to show on the tabloids (小报). I think since two years ago when he won another championship for China on the World Cup. Such achievements, I imagine, would take a great deal of determination from a person.

Although that's not the only reason I admire him. For as far as I know, he's pretty active in charity events. He established a charity fundation for children with cancers. And adorsed (代言) other charity foundations as well. I mean, there are many famous sports people out there, and yeah they are indeed dedicated to their career. But I haven't seen many of them being involved in charity causes. So I think what he does has really positive social influences.

Anyway, I think he's worth the admiration, and will continue to watch and support him matches.

Part 3

1) What kinds of people are popular at work?

I think it should be someone who is easy-going social wise and professional on a working level. On one hand, an easy-going person can establish a friendly working environment where relationships are less intense, and people can raise work-related questions freely, hence, benefiting the whole team. Who doesn't like someone friendly? On the other hand, it is workplace after all, so one should be professional and know his or her work scope clearly, be dedicated to the job and support their peer.

2) Are bosses more popular than employees at work?

Yeah, I think so. To be honest, it's kinda normal for employees to be nice and obedient to their bosses, so they can leave good impressions, have higher possibilities to get promoted or simply have a friendly working environment. After all, nobody wants to offend their bosses every day. So, from a realist point of view, the bosses are quite popular. Moreover, it definitely takes some personal charisma to be a leader and guide the whole team, so bosses tend to be inspiring, charming and interesting. Therefore, yes, I believe bosses are more likely to be more popular than employees at work.

17. 一次非常忙碌的经历

Describe a time you were very busy

You should say:

When it happened

Where you were

What you did

And explain why you were busy

Well, so far the busiest time of my life was my senior year in high school five years ago.

As you know, Chinese students have to take the college entrance exam, which is

literally a life-and-death exam, because it would decide what level of university you could attend, and in China, getting a degree and diploma is the first priority (第一要务) for employers who are looking for hire. It's fair to say, in a sense, this exam would consequently affect our future careers, so everyone will work at full capacity (全力以赴) to do it.

So as you can imagine, every day I was under huge pressure, and what is worse, my daily schedule was incredibly tight. I had to spend all of my waking hours studying and preparing for the exam, which left me no time to chill out (放松). Usually, my day started at 5:30, and I had to get to school before 7. And then, my whole day was fully occupied with 5 classes in the morning and 4 in the afternoon. On top of that, we were required to take the evening class from 6 to 10. I know it sounds hard to believe, but that was exactly how I spent my senior year.

Luckily, I was not alone. All of my classmates were all as stressed out as I was. And looking back, it actually feels good knowing that there're friends fighting together for our dreams. And now I have lived through (经历) that darkest time, and that experience has become kind of precious memory, and I definitely become stronger and tougher, it's like nothing will ever bring me down (击倒我). So although it's been a torture, I'm actually pretty grateful.

1) Are you often busy?

Being busy is often seen as a badge of honor and a marker of self-worth, it brings a lot of stress to handle. I don't like being busy, so when I have a feeling that I am about to get into such a situation, I will try to shorten my to-do list and adjust my mind. To me, free time is equally important as productive days, because it is crucial to my physical and mental health. If I have spare time, I would rather read some books or go traveling.

2) What are the advantages and disadvantages when people keep busy?

There are certainly some benefits that come with keeping busy. Firstly, staying busy is a great way to combat negative emotions and stay positive. When our plans are in progress, we feel hopeful and motivated. Secondly, busy people are more inclined to have a schedule, set goals and prioritize their workload so they become more productive. On the other hand, If we are unable to complete tasks or uphold the many obligations we have dedicated ourselves to, we may end up feeling guilty, or as if we've let others down, which is a disadvantage of keeping busy. Also, busyness may lead to sacrificing our physical well-being for the sake of getting tasks done.

18. 交通拥堵

Describe a time when you were stuck in a traffic jam

You should say:

When it happened

Where you were stuck

What you did while waiting

And explain how you felt in the traffic jam

I lived in the school dormitory on weekday during my high school years and went home every weekend. My father picked me up every Friday afternoon. It was about a thirty-minute drive to go home. Actually, we were stuck in traffic jam frequently. Because it was always the rush hour when we went home.

Among all the gridlock (交通堵塞) situations, the most impressive one was before a typhoon hit the city. We drove for less than ten minutes and were blocked on the viaduct. As usual, I took out my homework and started writing. But soon, it was getting darker and darker because of the typhoon. It was too gloomy(黑暗的, 阴暗的) for me to read. So, I decided to take a nap. After I woke up, I was still stuck in the traffic jam for more than an hour. I looked out of the

window. It was already raining and the wind was whistling by (风呼啸而过). I felt so hungry and anxious. Bad weather brought an uncomfortable mood. At this point, my desire to return home was overwhelming (巨大的, 压倒性的). I could even imagine the delicious dinner waiting for me on the table. I talked with my father, guessing what my mom had prepared for dinner. That feeling was so intense that I can recall it clearly now. Finally, after an hour, we got home.

The feeling of being stuck on the road is uncomfortable and anxious. Especially when you are urged to do something.

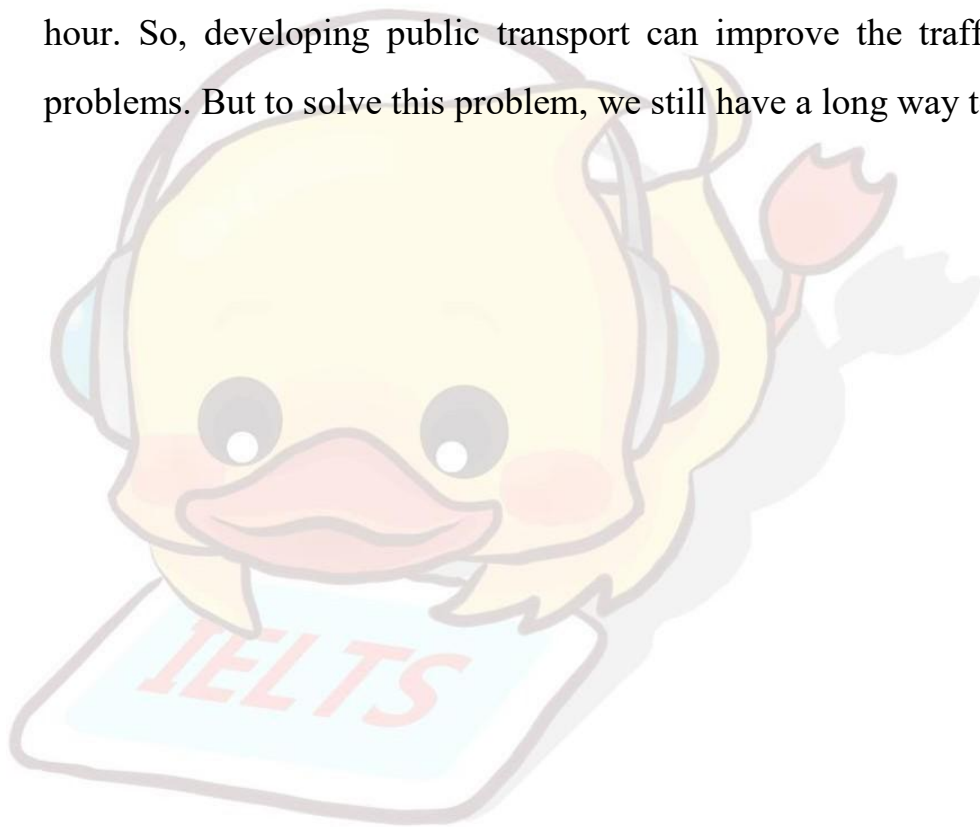
Part 3

1) How can we solve the traffic jam problem?

To solve the traffic jam, I think there are several measures that can be implemented. First, we may change our working habits. The Internet can now be used to connect people. More people could work from home. Meetings can be held as video conferences. Second, Public transport and cycling are available when travelling to a near place, which can reduce the number of vehicles on the road. This can relieve the traffic pressure to a great extent. Third, based on the second point, the public transport needs to be reliable and efficient, which requires government investment. The government may tax drivers. In London, for example, there is a congestion charge. This helps to raise money for better public transport.

2) Do you think developing public transportation can solve traffic jam problems?

Actually, I don't totally agree that developing public transport can solve the traffic jam problems. Public transportation is a fundamental part of dealing with traffic jam problems. It can relieve the traffic pressure to some extent. But it is obvious that first-tier cities like Beijing or Shanghai, with a well-developed public transport system, are still confronted with serious traffic jam problems. Basically, the huge population makes it difficult to solve the problem of traffic congestion. Besides, a lot of people haven't accepted the concept of green travel yet. They tend to travel alone now. Cars and road space are not used efficiently, which causes traffic jams during the rush hour. So, developing public transport can improve the traffic jam problems. But to solve this problem, we still have a long way to go.



P2&P3 保留题

1、壮志未酬

Describe an ambition that you haven't achieved

You should say:

What it is

Why you haven't achieved it

What you did

And how you felt about it



我一直想留学，学习教育心理学，获得这方面的硕士学位。这个事情我准备了三年了，前两年因为疫情，不能考雅思，而且安全问题也让人担忧，不能成行。今年我申请了香港的院校，并且提前看了很多心理学方面的书。真的希望可以顺利去上学。

I've been thinking about studying abroad for a master's degree in education psychology. Well, it's a big plan for me, 'cause this area is completely new to me. I majored in finance in university and learnt nothing about education or psychology. But this thought didn't come to me out of blue.(这个想法并不是突然有的) I was inspired by a friend who is now a qualified therapist. She mainly helps problematic children to get back on the normal track. (正常生活轨道) Her work looked so rewarding that it raised my interests as well.

But unfortunately, the COVID-19 made studying abroad impossible. I would have to be quarantined (被隔离) each time I travelled. Even worse, the IELTS exam gets cancelled continuously(雅思考试不断被取消). I couldn't even submit my IELTS grades! So, I decided to wait till this epidemic fades away. Some of my friends advised me to just study in the country, 'cause it's so unsafe traveling to another country. Well, it sounds like a good idea, but it's not really part of my plan.

I always believe the study of psychology is much more mature in the western universities. They've had a longer history applying psychological treatment to

patients, and also they put in big efforts to do experiments. I'm in my mid-20's. I've figured out why I want to study. I want the meat, not the bones. (我想要的是内容，而不是形式) I want to approach the experts in this field, to learn from them, to observe their work, and to have them guide my essay writing in person. I know that this experience alone would be a great asset to my future career, that is, if I do take the path to be an education therapist.

So yes, this year, I applied to two schools in HongKong, and I hope I can make one of them. Besides, I took a part time job in an outside school training center when I first graduated. I have worked with hundreds of children. It was a really rewarding but what bothered me a lot was, some of my students were very smart, diligent and well-behaved. However, they just couldn't make it in the school system. Their grades looked were low, the parents were disappointed, and the children felt guilty.

(1) What ambitions do children usually have?

I think most children talk big on their dreams. Some of them want to become scientists, while others aim to become astronauts. Their fantasy in these fancy jobs probably come from their parents and teachers' admiration to these works. Well, most people believe that these highly-skilled professionals should be respected and they somehow pour their thoughts to their children, hoping them to study hard to become one of these great people. Yeah, so children would have these ambitions build in them in their early education. These are good ambitious though. We should encourage them, right?

(2) Why are some people very ambitious in their work?

Well, if one is ambitious at work, he/she is certainly to get good return from it. For one, if you work hard, your superior will see it and when the time is right, you may be promoted. Also, you will be better paid. Well, when you are an adult,

who doesn't pursue a high salary and social status? Another reason I can think of is that when someone has ambitions in work, he/she will gain personal growth as well. We're all lifelong learners in this day and age. Learning itself can make us feel content and fulfilled.



2、生活中离不开的东西

Describe something that you can't live without(not a computer/phone)

You should say:

What it is

What you do with it

How it helps you in your life

And explain why you can't live without it

我有一本形影不离的手账本。我去哪里都会带上这个小本子，我不仅在上面记录每天的日常生活和任务，还会随手写下一些我的生活感想，并定期列一些小目标。这本本子帮助我记录下了许多生活中有趣的瞬间，也帮助我提醒自己不断努力实现自己的目标。我现在几乎离不开我的手账本，如果没有它的话，我会忘记许多琐碎的事情，也会忘记许多有趣的事。

I have a journal, and I always carry it wherever I go. I've been journaling since middle school, after learning that famous figures like Albert Einstein, Marie Curie and Leonardo da Vinci recorded experiences and sketched out (草拟) ideas. In most cases, I use it to write down to-do lists and capture my thoughts. This journal has helped me to keep track of (记录) my experiences throughout the day, be it a funny conversation or a new recipe that I like. In addition, it is more convenient to write things down instead of keeping a running tally of (记账) to-do items in my head. I can cross things off as I complete them and get a great sense of accomplishment. I also use this journal to do some simple sketches, which allows my imagination to run wild (横行). The inspiration that pops up while I'm brainstorming through sketching often surprises me. For instance, the stories I come across in real life

may inspire my work in literature. And with this journal, I can write down my thoughts and improve my working memory. Now, I can hardly live without my journal. Without it, I may easily forget what to do for the day and lose the memory of many interesting things. Once I didn't bring the journal with me when embarking on a journey with my friends. By the day we came back home, I found that I could hardly remember what we did in the first few days of the trip, which was very disappointing. Ever since then, I decided to bring it with me, wherever I travel.

(1) Why are children attracted to new things (such as electronics)?

People are born with a sense of curiosity. Compared to adults, children have less experiences and thus are more easily attracted by new things. If we look at this phenomenon from the perspective of neuroscience, this kind of novelty is so powerful because, in evolutionary terms, we pay attention to what's new to determine whether it's a threat. In other words, children are exploring this world by paying attention to new things and get motivation from this exploration to learn, work and succeed. Research shows that the tendency to seek out novel experiences often declines with age. Children are not bound with the routines that we have established, which makes it more likely for them to stray from familiar experiences.

(2) Why do some grown-ups hate to throw out old things (such as clothes)?

For many people, things carry memories and meanings. The clothes that one wears when meeting her husband, the first house that a couple buys when they get married and the old watch inherited from one's father — these things are heavily loaded with our emotions and memories. It feels like discarding memory or experience when throwing them away. Moreover, for many elder people, these things also carry significant meanings that are unique and unduplicable. For instance, my grandma has kept an old porcelain teacup with

her for decades. My grandpa, who has passed away for years, bought her this teacup when they were in their 20s. It's more like a love token for them and a relic of my grandfather. As a result, although the cup is worn-out, my grandma never thinks about throwing it away, because she wants to keep this beautiful memory of her youth and affection.



3、想要的公寓或房子

Describe a house or an apartment you would like to live in

You should say:

What it is like Where it would be

Why you would like to live in this house/apartment And how you feel about this house/apartment

我想住在一间海边的别墅里，和家人一起，还有我们家的狗。别墅里面有大的窗户，白天阳光照进来非常明亮。还有一个大花园，种满了植物。别墅非常靠近海边，我们可以每天去沙滩上，在沙滩上晒太阳或在海里游泳或冲浪。住在这样的房子里一定非常舒适，我会非常享受这样惬意的和家人呆在一起的时光。

Speaking of this topic, the first scenario that came to my mind is a villa near the beach, where I could live with my family and my two dogs. Inside the villa there would be large French windows (落地窗) so that the sunshine can drop in during the day, making the whole inner space bright. In the day, I could sit on the balcony, reading books, drinking tea, enjoying the sea breeze (海风), and looking through the French windows to the enormous ocean. There would also be a big garden in front of the house, filled with different kinds of plants and flowers. I would feel a huge amount of joy playing with my dogs in the garden.

The villa is very close to the sea. We can go to the beach every day to swim or surf in the sea, or just to bask in the sunshine. Imagine such a scene: white clouds floating in the sky, and you walking on the beach barefoot (赤脚走路). The raging waves (汹涌澎湃的海浪) crashing on the shore. Seabirds flying

freely in the sky.

As the sunlight filter through (透过) the clouds, you would have a wonderful view of the ocean bottom, where there are colorful corals, aquatic plants and all kinds of fish, like butterfly, clown and tropical swim on by.

It must be very comfortable to live in a house like this, where I could get rid of all the stress arising from work, study, and other things. It is also a great chance to reconnect to my family and I would really enjoy spending such a wonderful time with them

(1) What kinds of apartments are the most popular?

There are many reasons that apartments are popular. From the perspective of renting an apartment for an international student, I believe that studios are one of the most popular apartment types. Because a studio is well-equipped and affordable, which suits students the most.

(2) What are the differences between houses that young people and old people like?

The needs of the young and old in a house are different. However, the main difference lies in the fact that while younger members of the family are growing and getting more independent by the day, the elderly are aging and will need constant long-term care. As older people age in place, they require more mobility and long-term care, while the young people care more about the location and price.

4、免费物品

Describe something you received for free

You should say:

What it was

Who you received it from

Where you received it
And how you felt about it

邻居送的蔬菜。其实我跟邻居并没有很熟，平时也没怎么见到过他们。那天快中午的时候，突然有人敲门，开门后发现是邻居。他们拿了一个蛋糕和几个复活节彩蛋给我，并祝我复活节快乐。我当时觉得挺诧异的，不过还是感到非常开心，这一年圣诞节的时候，我送了一个圣诞节糕点，还有一些小零食给邻居家的小姑娘。

The most impressive free item I received was an Easter present from my neighbor.

In fact, I didn't know my neighbors very well before the whole thing happened, as they are an old couple from Russia. Because of our different living habits (生活习惯) and language barriers (语言障碍), I didn't see or talk to them very often. So, we just had simple greetings, and no in-depth discussions (深入交谈). I remember last Easter, at almost noon, someone knocked on the door. I wondered who it was, and when I opened the door, it was my Russian neighbor. They brought me a little cake that looked like they had baked it themselves and a few colorful Easter eggs., They wished me a happy Easter, and gave me a warm hug. I was surprised at the time, but still very happy. Although I don't have the habit of celebrating Easter, it feels good to be remembered (被人惦记的感觉很好). I happily accepted the gifts and immediately sent pictures of the cake and eggs to my parents and friends to share the joy. . The cake given by the neighbors was sweet, and the painted eggas delicious. From that day on, every time I ran into (碰见) my neighbors when I went out, I would greet them warmly. Although I still can't speak Russian, I tried to communicate with them more often. Our relationship suddenly became closer. For Christmas last year, I went to the supermarket to buy gifts in advance (提前). On Christmas Eve, I prepared gifts early, and at noon, I gave a Christmas pastry (糕点), some fruits and some snacks to the neighbor's little granddaughter. When the neighbors opened the door and saw it was me, they

welcomed me

warmly and thanked me with a big smile.

(1) Do you think people should pay for higher education? Why?

Well, I don't think people should pay for it, higher education should be free to everyone. Everybody knows that higher education is very important for a country. The future society will soon belong to batches of new graduates. College students will directly affect the whole society. Therefore, I think the country should cultivate university students like training the army, free of charge. This is a worthwhile investment. Secondly, there are many children from poor families who have lost the opportunity to receive higher education because they cannot afford the tuition fees. This creates inequality in education. This inequality will be detrimental to the progress and development of the country, and it also violates the equality of national education.

(2) Is it good or bad for people to have free education in the future?

It is good for people to have free education in the future. The benefits that free education can naturally bring is the improvement of social productivity. As we all know, science and technology are the primary productive forces, but where does science and technology come from? There is no doubt that it comes from learning. Free education means that everyone can afford to go to school and enjoy the right to receive education, so naturally, the per capita academic qualifications and quality will be greatly improved, which is beneficial to all walks of life. The estrangement between people can also be reduced, which is naturally conducive to the progress of the society.

5、小时候的玩具

Describe the toy you played with as a child

You should say:

What it was

What it was like

How you played with it
And explain why you played with it

我想说的是小时候姨妈送给我洋娃娃。我姨妈住在海南，我们一年难得见一次面。每次见面她都会送我玩具。所有玩具中我最喜欢的是这个洋娃娃，大大的眼睛，金黄色头发，还有两套配套的衣服可以装扮她。我甚至可以给她化妆，涂指甲油。这个洋娃娃对我来说像一个朋友，陪伴我走过童年。

I want to talk about a beautiful doll that accompanied me throughout my childhood. It was a gift from my elder auntie who lived in Hainan at the time. Well, Hainan is down in the south of the country, and we lived in the north.. Traveling was not only expensive, but also difficult at the time. So, I hardly ever saw my auntie. But each time I saw her, she would give me a fancy gift. And the doll was a gift from her, when I was four years old.

I abandoned (抛弃) all my old toys when I received this cute doll. It was over ten inches tall, with big blue eyes and blonde hair. Growing up on the inland of the country, I never even imagined that people's eyes could be so blue! So, it was exotic (有异域风情的) to me! Best of all, there were two spare outfits (两套备用衣服) that came with the doll. I could dress her and I could put make-up on her, as the materials on her face were silica. I even polished her nails with my mother's nail polish. There were just so many fun ways to play with her.

I grew attached to her, not only because of the fun things I could do with her, but also for friendship and comfort.. (我渐渐对她依赖起来，不仅因为我可以和她做很多事情，而且我和她发展除了友谊) Since I was the only child at home, I really needed a friend. I was sometimes left at home alone when my parents were both called away for work. I pretended that she was my little sister.

And I would talk to her, telling her my favorite animals, games, and my dreams.

I was a bit introverted as a kid

(我小时候有点内向) and was always shy to talk to others. But with this doll, I felt so relaxed. I could let out my secrets in front of her without feeling nervous. So yeah, it was really the best toy I've ever had.



(1) Do boys and girls like the same toys?

I don't think so. Girls generally prefer pinkish and girly toys, such as the doll, musical instruments or the bling bling make-up toys. They seem to be naturally interested in these things. My niece is a good example. You never need to teach her how to dress up a doll. She does it perfectly. However, boys are more into cars, remote controlled jets or robots. They often beg their parents for such cool toys. And some boys are even passionate about fixing mechanical things. Few girls would take interest in such mechanical toys, I'm afraid. So no, boys and girls aren't into the same type of toys.

(2) What do parents usually buy for their children to make them happy?

Well, kids love snacks and toys. Almost everyone knows this. So I imagine that most parents don't mind taking their children to the supermarket to shop for candies, lollipops and chips. Also, the toys section in the supermarket are often full of children. You could see the light in a child when he/she is taken in front of those fancy toys. I mean, if you have wandered in the supermarket, notice what the family often have in their shopping cart if they have kids shopping along. I don't think their children would be happy without anything especially for them. So yeah, to make children happy, parents only need to buy them what they want.

6、坏掉又修好的东西

Describe something in your home you broke and then repaired

You should say:

What it is

How you broke it

How you repaired it
And how you felt about it

这个题目让我想起了我三年前买的戴森吸尘器。他基本上是我家里不可缺少的好助手，帮助我去吸入房间里面每一粒灰尘，我有的时候甚至会跟姐妹们开玩笑，要是没有这个吸尘器，我可怎么活。但不幸的是我乌鸦嘴了。有一天当我像往常一样打扫房间的时候忽然间闻到一股烧焦的味道，我有种不祥的预感。终于他开始向我抱怨了吗？所以我不得不把它拆开来，然后看看它储存污垢的容器以及检查它的管道，到最后我发现是滚轮卡在了通风口。所以我就把它搬了回去，然后放了一点橡胶固定住。然后他终于又开始运作了。成功修好了之后，我非常的累，但同时也很有满足感，因为这是我第一次去修一个原来好像修理工才能做的事情。原本我都要放弃了，但好在我坚持了下来，另外一个事情是千万不要说一些预言，如果自己也不是 100%确定的话

This topic just reminds me of the tragic story of my Dyson vacuum which I bought over three years ago. It actually **serves as an indispensable assistant taking care of the hygiene of the house**, (管理卫生的不可或缺的家庭助手) as it takes in every single piece of dust into his lung to provide me with a clean and neat room. I just joked to my sister that I couldn't imagine what my life without him. **I hoped that by saying that, I hadn't jinxed myself!** (千万别乌鸦嘴) One day when I was using it to do the chores and clean every corner of my room as usual, he suddenly **gave off a burnt smell** (散发烧焦的气味), **giving me a sudden sense of foreboding** (有不祥的预感). After all those years, he had finally started to complain.. So, I simply took him apart to see what was wrong with him. At first I removed the dust catcher and **saw straight through the tube** (目光直直的穿过管道). Luckily there was nothing in there. And then I checked the roller ball and also the suction area by **unscrewing the gears** (扭下来零件) and **that is what was exactly causing the issue** (就是他在导致问题). **Some gadgets slid out to block the suction section** (一些小零件

划落堵住了吸尘口) so, I simply clicked it forward. And in order to make it steady, I had some rubber glued to the tube so that it could fit in perfectly. After I turned it on, my old pal fortunately started to work again.

I was wild with joy (高兴坏了) after all that exhausting and unhygienic work. I was so proud of myself for mending something usually fixed by a mechanic. I was about to quit halfway through but I am so happy I persisted..差不多要放弃的时候坚持了下来还成功了) Another lesson I have drawn from this experience is to never say something that you don't want to come true, because you just end up jinxing yourself!!

(1) Are IT-related jobs valued more by society?

In the past, those job occupations related to information technology didn't receive so much attention simply because people hadn't seen its full potential. For instance, we only used the mobile phone to keep in contact with friends and family and the live streaming trade hadn't been such a lucrative field. However, thanks to the introduction of 5G technology and big data, we've got to quickly download softwares and people can even conclude from statistics about different peoples personality and a preference for different products. It's fair to say the 21st-century is the age of information technology, so it's not unusual that on jobs related to this industry are becoming increasingly valued by society.

(2) Is the quality of products worse than before?

I cannot give an exclusive answer because you know there are all assortment of products in the market nowadays. It is clear to see that people enjoy a wider range of products which just brings convenience to the daily life. However, due to the mass production and the fact that an increasing number of manufacturers start to be obsessed with profit, they may try to sacrifice quality for the sake of money. A vivid example was that my mom told me when she was young there

wouldn't be so much trouble with some electronic appliances, while nowadays all those annoying glitches will frequently occur and require for updates which may be an indication of the decrease in quality.

7、有趣的谈话

Describe an interesting conversation

*You should say
Who you spoke with
Where you were
What the conversation was about
And explain why you think it was interesting*



在柏林的时候，跟一位看起来 80 多岁的老太太聊天，听她讲关于柏林墙的历史。之前只是从历史书中知道的这一段历史，但历史书里的描述并不详细。老太太娓娓道来当时的往事，以及对她和普通人带来的切身的影响。我听完之后觉得很震撼，非常有感触。我认为这个谈话很有趣，因为我了解了只有当地人才体会过的过去。

Three years ago in December, I traveled around Europe for Christmas. While in Berlin, I got to chat in a café with an old local lady who looked to be in her 80's (80 左右的) and listened to her talk about Germany's post-World War II (二战后) history, which I only knew from the history books, but the descriptions in the history books were not detailed enough. (详细的). History books only describe the causes and consequences of World War II, and whoever lost or won, but there is very little information (少有提及) about the impact of the war on the local people, not to mention the views of civilians during the war. So, I was very happy when the old lady was willing to open up to me (愿意对我敞开心扉).

For example, she mentioned the Memorial to the Murdered Jews of Europe (欧洲被犹太人纪念碑), which is used to pay homage to (祭奠...) the Jews

killed in World War II. What I particularly admire about this, is that many countries do not have the courage to admit and face the mistakes they have made, and even avoid talking about some history. But this Memorial was not only built for the Jewish civilians who were brutally killed (被残忍杀害的犹太人), but also for the Germans to face and learn from history. It was built for the collective memory of the German nation (为德意志民族的集体记忆而建造), which shows the sincerity of their reflection on the war (对于战争反省的真诚). She also mentioned how their lives have changed dramatically in a very short time after the fall of the Berlin Wall (柏林墙的倒塌), and her gratitude and love for the free life she now has (对现在自由生活的感激和热爱). After listening to it, I felt very shocked and very emotional.

I thought this talk was interesting because I learned about the past that only local people have experienced, and I learned more about the courage of the German people to face history and reflect on their mistakes (反省错误).

(1) Do children have strong opinions?

This question varies from person to person. Some children are very assertive and always have strong opinions, while others are very timid. They listen to their parents and teachers on everything and have no opinions of their own. I personally think that in general, the older the child, the stronger opinions he or she has. This is because some parents worry that their children will become too cowardly and obedient due to lack of opinions, and even rely on parents to make decisions most of the time. Therefore, when children are young, parents will gradually cultivate their children's self-awareness and personality. When children become too assertive, disobedient and stubborn, parents are troubled by their strong opinions.

(2) Should parents request their kids to obey them?

I think it depends. Some children always like to fight against their parents during adolescence, which means they don't do what their parents tell them to do. I think in the face of such a situation, parents can not force their children to follow their wishes in some trivial matters. They should respect their children's wishes and let them do whatever they want. However, in some major issues, parents should also take care of their children and not let them do wrong things. For example, when a child makes some bad friends and wants to do some illegal things, parents should stop their children or use other methods to guide their children, so that the children do not do those wrong things and illegal things.

8、快乐活动

Describe a happy event you organized

*You should say:
What the event was
Where you had it
Who helped you to organized
And how you feel about it*

那是一个普通的星期二下午。我和我的几个好朋友在上完课后正准备回我们的宿舍。我们路过一个学生的活动场所。我凝视着晴朗的天空，想出了在大楼天台举行小型聚会的想法。作为一个高年级的本科生，似乎一切向前都是既诱人又可怕的。但是那个下午，那种逃离地面的想法，让一切都变得不重要了。我曾参加过几次盛大的聚会和时髦的夜总会，整夜跳舞。然而，所有这些盖茨比式的乐趣都无法像那个下午那样缓解我的疲劳。我认为快乐不一定伴随着强烈的感官刺激。能够和亲密的朋友呆在一起，无忧无虑地进行信任的交谈，还有辉煌的天空的完美景象，这些都是美好的快乐事件。

It was an ordinary Tuesday afternoon. I and a few of my close friends were heading back to our dormitory, after a lecture. We were passing by a students' activities facility. As I looked up at the clear sky, I came up with the idea to have a small gathering on the building's rooftop.

So, we went to the convenience store on the building's ground floor and picked

some snacks and drinks. On one side of the facility is a wall of stretching steps, allowing us to wander up to the top. So, we went up. There was a small garden on it, and a few chairs and tables alongside. We just sat down, sharing our snacks and drinking alcohol. . The breeze of late autumn was brisk and refreshing. As we were chatting, we forgot about how we were all facing the pressure of graduating and independence. Being a senior undergraduate, it seems everything going forward is both luring and terrifying. But that afternoon, the idea of an escape from the ground, made everything else seem irrelevant. We were singing and playing party games. Everyone laughed so hard as if we were on top of the world.

The joy and relaxation that afternoon was so e memorable. I could still see the sunset glimmering on everyone's face. I have been to several grand parties and trendy night clubs dancing all night long. Yet all those Gatsby- fun could never ease the fatigue out of me like that afternoon. I think joyfulness does not necessarily come along with strong sensory stimulation. Being able to stay with your intimate friends, having deep conversations without worry , under the blanket of a perfect sky is all it takes to have a wonderful happy event.

(1) How can parents help children to get organized

To cultivate children's good habits, the first is for parents to spare independence. Without the space for kids to organize by themselves, they cannot learn from executing parents' orders. And the second is to start with the subtle. By asking kids to organize their personal belongings such as toys and clothing, they may understand how tidiness could help them live a more comfortable life since losing a favourite toy may be excruciating to them. Also, it is critical to set the principle that without serious exception, children shall bear the outcome of their behaviour. Parents should not help them to finish a project at the last minute or help them find the missing stationery.

(2) On what occasions do people need to be organized

I would say on all occasions. But clearly, when people are undertaking a serious public service mission, such as pandemic control, they should definitely organize better. It is very common for mandatory quarantine to be issued in China, yet social distancing could lead to social isolation then cause catastrophes like starvation or unavailable medical urgent assistance. When government officers issue the plan for quarantine, they should build comprehensive understandings of citizens' basic needs and run some essential cost-benefit calculations. Only after good plan-making comes good implementation. Compared to horrible business foresight, sloppy policy-making is more concerned with the essence of people's livelihood. Hence, all public servants, as much as all the gratitude we shall offer, must think twice and get organized.

9、对社会有用的人

Describe a person whose work is useful to the society

You should say:

Who the person is

What type of work he/she does

And explain why you think his/her work is useful to the society

我认为我们学校食堂的一位厨师对社会是有帮助的。给我印象最深的是一位中年女性。她煮的饺子是世界上最好的。饺子通常被认为是家和团圆的象征，所以毫不夸张地说，她的热情举动让我们很多人都有了家的感觉。而当你是一个在陌生城市的大学生时，这太有用处。

当我们在评估一个职业的效用时，我们一般会把价值和金钱结果或政治影响等同起来。但可以说，马斯洛的需求层次理论可以适用于此。因此，我认为餐饮业的工作是特别有用的。

I think a cook in a school cafeteria is fundamental to the school system especially to us students. The canteen in my school could cater to several hundreds of students at once, hence there are about a dozen food windows available. Behind these windows are all talented and friendly cooks. Yet the one

I was most impressed by was a middle-aged female. She cooked the best dumplings in the world. Even though it doesn't seem challenging to cook dumplings she still had the best knowledge about how long should everyone's dumplings need to be boiled for even when we order them separately. And I remember last year, on the day of Dongzhi., a traditional Chinese festival, Our custom is to have dumplings on that night, so the line that day was long. But eventually, not only did everyone receive their food right but we were also offered a free tangerine as festival blessings. She could always recall everyone's usual order , and she often gives out free additional dumplings. Dumplings are often regarded as a symbol of home and reunion, so it's no exaggeration to say that her warm gesture has made many of us feel at home. And that's greatly useful when you are a college student in an unfamiliar city, which is, by the way, the most common case for college students.

When we are evaluating the utility of a career, we generally equalize value and monetary outcome or political influence. But arguably, the theory of Maslow's hierarchy of needs could apply here. Maslow has divided human needs into five categories in the structure of a pyramid. And he argues the most basic needs of humans are psychological including food and water, all the way up to self-actualization. Therefore, I think that catering work is especially useful.

(1) What jobs are well-paid?

The answer lies in the stock market. You can see that the most valuable public companies nowadays are big tech companies like Apple or Facebook, so the jobs within these firms, often software developers are generally well-paid. Also, the traditional jobs with higher social status, like lawyers and doctors, make a considerable fortune. I think this would give us another criterion of well-paid jobs, that the tuition fees of different majors in universities are proportional to the future salary of the students with the degree. Meanwhile, as remuneration may be referred to as compensation, the higher risk of the job is a common sign that the worker would get a bigger check. So workers at height or underground

could be better paid.

(2) What are the changes in working conditions?

Well, the pandemic has definitely impacted everyone's working conditions. People work from home on an unprecedented scale. Therefore, online video meetings are no longer the exclusive experiences of several groups of elite lawyers in different cities. Also, cloud collaboration has become popular since in-person contact may be unavailable. And it does save us much time on useless confirmation on subtle changes of a document, which is also a new trend for companies to promote paperless office. That allowing workers to choose flexible working hours is another change in working conditions. It is pretty nice since not everyone is the most productive during the same daytime.

10、远距离步行

Describe a long walk you ever had

You should say

When this happened?

Where you walked

Who you were with

And explain how you felt about this long walk

我想说的是一场令我印象深刻的远距离步行。那是在我初中的时候，学校组织所有同学去春游，地点在北京动物园。我们一个班为一组，坐大巴车前往动物园，到了之后就全部要自己步行游览了。和我一起的还有非常激动的班里同学们，以及我们的班主任，她负责组织纪律。说实话，我没有想到动物园那么大，我当时还未发育完全，是班里比较矮的一个，所以要费劲跟上大部队，基本没有什么时间仔细观察动物。当时我们整个班在动物园里走了一个下午，最后大家都筋疲力尽。我认为尽管这次长距离步行很累，我还是很有收获的，不仅能够看到形形色色的动物，还和小伙伴们度过了一段快乐的时光。

I'd like to talk about a long walk which really impressed me. **When I was a middle high school student, our school organized all students to go for a spring**

outing (春游). I remember all of us were in good spirits (兴高采烈) and prepared lots of snacks for the journey. Our destination was Beijing Zoo.

We took the bus to head for the zoo class by class. After we arrived, all tourists have to visit the zoo on foot. I was accompanied by (随 行) all of my classmates, who were so excited about this trip, and our form teacher (班主任), who was in charge of (负责) keeping good discipline. To be honest, I didn't expect the zoo to be that large. In my high school years, I was quite a late developer (发育迟缓), so I was shorter than most of my classmates. It took me a lot of time to catch up with (赶上) the whole class, so I basically had little time to observe animals closely. All I did was run and ogle trying to follow my friends and form teacher, while gasping for breath (气喘吁吁).

At that time, our whole class spent the afternoon in the zoo. All of us were completely worn out (疲惫不堪). In my opinion, although this long walk is exhausting for me, I still have some gains through this journey. I was not only able to get close to all kinds of rare animals, I also spent a joyful time with all of my friends. Even though they kept running and leaving me behind, I guess that's just the nature of all middle school students.

(1) What outdoor activities do people like

People enjoy all kinds of outdoor activities, especially something to enjoy the beautiful scenery and relax themselves. In their spare time, people living in cities love driving to the nearest countryside and treat themselves with the view of village. As a result, many farmers even transform their home into farm stays, attracting different city people. They can also have delicious local cuisine in farm stays, and go sightseeing in the farmlands. Generally speaking, people love sightseeing, because it will not only relief people from stress, it is also an amazing chance for people to take selfie and upload onto social media. By the way, when visiting farm stays, you can also make new friends, which helps to build a wide range of contacts.

(2) What are the differences between the outdoor activities children did in the

past and now

In my opinion, nowadays children have less and less freedom to choose their favorite outdoor activities, because children have less outdoor places to play in city and they are more aware of their safety. In the past, the urban area is limited, and most of children live in rural area, so they would play in villages or on mountains in their spare time. Many children were lost or injured while playing. However, now, with the development of urbanization, more and more children live in city, and there is little space for them to play dangerous games, so they have to go to the park. In addition, children are well educated now, so they have acquired knowledge to intentionally stay away from wild places.

11、想共度时光的人

Describe someone you really like to spend time with

You should say:

Who this person is

How you knew him/her

What you usually do together

And explain why you like to spend time with him/her

我超级喜欢和我外婆呆在一起。外婆今年已经 70 多岁了，她年轻时是个很有才华的漂亮女子。我特别喜欢听她讲她们那个年代的故事。我和我的表姐表弟们都喜欢去外婆家。大家在一起经常边打扑克边，边听外婆讲那些年代久远的故事。我喜欢有外婆在那种安宁，温馨的感觉。

Well, I am going to talk about my grandmother on my mother's side. She's such a lovely person. I find it really relaxing spending time with her so I visit her as soon as I have holidays.

My grandmother is in her mid 70's and was born into a family that had a

reputation for knowing how to make Chinese medicine (我外婆出生在一个中药世家). While she was growing up, she followed her father to the mountains to dig herbs. Their footprints stretched across ten mountains. You would think that her father would have instilled the responsibilities in her to be a Chinese doctor so she could inherit (继承) the family's herb business, since she was so diligent (勤劳) and smart, yet he didn't. He gave the business to his son.

However, my grandma didn't stop learning just because of this absurd family plan(荒谬的家庭安排). She was a resilient (坚韧的) woman and kept researching Chinese herbs. Over the years, she has used her knowledge and skills to heal so many patients. Ironically, if you ask for her medical qualifications, she doesn't have any, but if you ask her for an effective treatment method, she may just have one! For this reason, she's well respected in my hometown. I learnt that when I was a kid. Whenever I hung out with her on the street, I would receive extra friendly attention(我会得到格外友好的关注) and to be honest, that was one of the reasons I loved spending time with her.

Now that my grandma is getting old, she seems to be more interested in telling stories to her grandchildren. Whenever my cousins and I gather in her house, she makes tea for us, and then we play some poker while she shares some of her life experiences with us. I totally love those moments, as they are so peaceful and loving.

(1) What kind of people are easy to get along with?

Well, personally I like to spend time with people who are easygoing. This kind of people often have smiles on their faces and they are also good listeners. It's always pleasant to have them around. Also, I think most people would like those who are positive, and don't judge others or talk behind others' backs. In another

word, people who are kind, honest and optimistic are easy to get along with. See, you don't want to be with someone who always complains about others. That's gonna put you in anxiety too. And being with those who always look at the bright side of life is cheerful, isn't it? You could be inspired by them at times. And most importantly, your time spent with them often turns out worthwhile.

(2) How do leaders get along with their subordinates?

I would reckon that most leaders are quite strict when their subordinates are around. They often wear a serious look and speak firmly to show their authority. Well, it's understandable for the sake of management. However, outside the workplace, some leaders may be quite easygoing and they do try and build a friendly relationship with their subordinates. For example, in China, the leaders would treat their team with a big meal every now and then to build the team spirit. At the dining table, the leader usually act like an old brother/sister and try to convey the message that their subordinates can count on them. Also, the leaders buy gifts for or give red envelops to the subordinates on some traditional festivals.

12、语言学习

Describe something that helped you learn a language

You should say

What it is

What language you learned

How it helped you learn the language

And how you felt about it

德语角给我帮助很大。我学习的是德语，众所周知德语真的非常难，尤其是语法非常难。我一开始自学，后面发现没有语言环境无法真正理解德语，于是我就去了本地的德语角，那里有德语老师，德语学习者，最重要的是有德国人。我们聊天，讨论，除了德语什么也不使用，对我的帮助很大。我推荐这个方法给所有学习德语，学习外语的人。

You must have heard of the foreign language corner, right? It is usually outside of the library or in a fixed corner of the city park. People who learn a certain foreign language will go there to communicate and study at a certain time every week. Sometimes there will be native speakers or foreign language teachers. Everyone provides free help. In addition to English, the foreign language I have studied is German. So, the German corner in the city park has helped me a lot.

As we all know, German is difficult, especially in grammar terms . When I started learning German, I was self-taught (自学的) . It was fine at the beginning, but as I went on, I found that I couldn't really understand German without a language environment. So, after looking up (查阅) local German learning groups online, I went to the German Corner in the city park. The German Corner meets twice a week, Wednesday at 7pm and Saturday at 7pm. There are German teachers, German learners, and most importantly, Germans, all of whom offer selfless advice on German learning (所有人都无私地给出德语学习的建议) . We chat, discuss, and use no language other than German (除了德语什么语言都不用) . In the beginning, I felt that the German Corner was a challenge for me. Although I studied for a long time, when I really faced a German, I was still very nervous, and I found that I had some pronunciation problems, not to mention listening difficulties. But I am so grateful that after a period of German Corner study, I am now able to communicate with Germans on daily topics. And with everyone's encouragement, I plan to apply for the German B1 level exam next month, I hope I can be lucky enough to pass it in one go. (一次性通过考试) .

The German Corner has helped me a lot, both from a confidence building perspective and from a language learning perspective (不管是从自信心的建立角度还是从语言学习角度) . I recommend this method to anyone learning

German, or any foreign language.

(1) What difficulties do people face when learning a language?

I think most people will encounter various difficulties when learning a new language, such as difficulties with pronunciation, difficulties with vocabulary memory and difficulties with ways of thinking. I think the difficulty of learning a foreign language mainly depends on the difference between the mother tongue and the foreign language. Of course, the more unfamiliar the language, the more difficult it is to learn. As far as pronunciation is concerned, a native speaker of Mandarin will definitely be confused by the tones of Cantonese, and even more confused by the continuous tones of Hokkien. And even native speakers of Cantonese have difficulty learning languages like Thai and Vietnamese because of the differences in pronunciation, not to mention the differences in pronunciation between Russian, Italian and German.

(2) Do you think language learning is important? Why?

Yes, of course. By learning a language, you can understand the culture of this country and feel the charm of this country. Conversing and reading directly in this language is very different from the experience translated by others. Take myself as an example. Because of learning German, I experienced the charm of the German language itself, and I met many good German friends in the process of learning. Through talking with them, I felt the different ways of understanding the world from another nation, and learned about the interesting ways of thinking under different national and cultural backgrounds. In the past, I only learned about Germany from books and TV media, but now I feel Germany more truly, and understand another world that I have never known before, which increases the experience of my life.

Describe a place in a village that you visited

You should say:

Where it is

When you visited this place

What you did there

And how you feel about this place

我想说的是一处我无意中发现的，令人印象深刻的乡村风景。每年暑假的时候，我都会回到奶奶家玩几天。奶奶家在河北的乡下，一个山脚下的小村子里。在我高一时，我又回到了奶奶家。某一天，我出门闲逛，戴着耳机一边听歌一边走路，不知不觉地就走到了山上，到了一个我从来没来过的小路。我突然发现在路边的草里隐藏着一个很大的山洞，好奇心驱使我过去一探究竟。山洞看起来是天然形成的，里面黑漆漆的什么都看不清。尽管是夏天，站在山洞口还是能感到里面非常凉爽，甚至有点阴森。我打开手机手电筒往里面照，还是什么都看不清，但是山洞里传来有东西扑扇翅膀的声音，我觉得可能是蝙蝠。尽管觉得很害怕，我还是在山洞门口拍了照，上传到社交媒体来纪念这一次不同寻常的经验。我感觉这是一次很酷的体验，但是人们在外面一个人行走时也应该注意安全，远离危险地带。

I'd like to talk about a secret place I found in the countryside, which was quite impressive. I always come to a nearby village to visit my grandparents, which is located in the outer ring (外环) of the Hebei province, and I stay at my grandma's house in a village at the foot of a mountain (在山脚下).

When I was a freshman at high school, I paid a visit to my grandma during the summer holiday as usual. One day, I was wandering (闲逛) on the street with my earphones in, listening to music. I had walked further that I realized. Unknowingly, I climbed onto the mountain and entered a path that I had never come to. All of a sudden, I noticed that there was a huge cave (山洞) hidden in the grass by the road. Curiosity drove me to approach to take a look (一探究竟). The cave seemed to be natural. Inside of the cave it was complete darkness. It

was **pitch-black** (一片漆黑) and I couldn't see a thing. Although it was summer, I could still feel the coolness in the cave, which was a kind of **creepy** (令人毛骨悚然).

I turned on the flashlight of my phone and still couldn't see anything. However, I heard something flapping in the cave. I thought it could be bats. **Despite my fear, I took pictures of the cave and uploaded them to social media to commemorate my unusual experience (纪念这段不同寻常的经历).** I think it was a cool experience for me, but I also want to remind all of my friends that you should stay away from dangerous zones especially in the countryside.

(1) Is there anything special about the villages in China?

I think the large number of farm stays is a feature of the villages in China. Currently, there are 560 million farmers in China, who are actively searching for other ways to make money besides agriculture, which is not that financially rewarding. Therefore, some farmers set up their own farm stays and attract visitors through social media. These farmers make use of the sceneries of the village, and cook local cuisines for their clients to win returning customers. Nowadays, farm stay industry is gaining momentum in China, as the government is calling for rural revitalization. By operating their farm stay, many farmers have lived a well-off life and gained more money than they used to make through farming.

(2) What do people usually do when going to a village?

I think it depends on what kinds of people who go to a village. If they are farmers, then they normally go to a village to do farm work. There is a lot of things farmers do, like sowing, ploughing, watering in spring and summer, and harvesting and storing in fall and winter. Village is like the office for farmers. On the other hand, if you don't live in countryside, then it's likely that you go to village for relaxation. Generally speaking, city people love visiting village in

their vacations. They will pay a visit to farm stays to enjoy some delicious local food. When staying in village, they can also enjoy the beautiful natural scenery of countryside.



14、有趣的歌曲

Describe an interesting song

*You should say:
What the song is
What story the song tells
Whether the song is popular
And explain why you think it is interesting*

目前为止，我听过的一首有趣的歌曲当属《狐狸叫》，它是挪威歌手伊尔维萨克兄弟为了宣传新一季脱口秀电视节目开播而制作的宣传歌曲，2013年在YouTube上传后顿时风靡全球，不到3天有了410万次的点击量。这首歌好似唱儿歌般总结了一批常见动物比如狗、猫、鸟、老鼠等的叫声，伊尔维萨克兄弟用无厘头的唱腔演绎了狐狸叫声的多种版本，出现了各种天马行空兼不断重复的拟声词汇，打破了以往的歌曲演绎唱法和风格。

Well, so far, one of the most interesting songs I've ever heard has been The Fox, also called What Does the Fox Say? It is a song made by the Norwegian singer Ylvis, a comedy duo(喜剧二人组) from Bergen, to promote the launch of a new season(新一季) of talk show TV programs.

The fox then became the accidental viral hit(意外爆红) released on YouTube in the

year of 2013, and there were 4.1 million hits (点击量) in less than three days, becoming Ylvis' breakout song(成名曲) and drawing international attention to the group. The music video by Ylvis explores the question of what the fox says. We know the cow says, "moo" and the dog says, "woof," but what about the fox? Is it a howl? Is it a squeak? The fox, like a

children's song, sums up the sound produced by common animals such as dogs, cats, birds, and mice, by adopting the seemingly illogical (天马行空) singing style to interpret various versions of the foxes' sound together with some unconstrained and flexible onomatopoeia wording (拟声词).

Their unrestrained and vigorous style that drips with talent (才华横溢) breaks the previous singing and style of song interpretation. If you have a look at its MV, you would definitely be attracted by its different performing style. At the beginning of MV, a group of handsome men and women dressed as animals held a party in a forest villa (森林别墅) accompanied by (伴随) their funny steps. Interestingly, some onomatopoeic words are engaging (有趣的、吸引人的) and full of fun, including ow, ow, ow and wa-pa-pa-pa-pa-pa-pow. It reminds me some unforgettable innocent days (天真烂漫的日子) of early childhood, just eating, talking, and playing with my friends. Also from its funny lyrics, what the singer conveys is not only about how the fox makes sound, but about how people can be to animals.. And I'd like to think that I do my part in being at one with nature.

(1) Why are many music competitions popular in China?

That's an interesting question. Well, I would elaborate it from the two main meaningful points. On the one hand, the content and design styles of these music competitions are really appealing. Let's say The Voice of China, China's largest and most-viewed reality singing talent show at the moment. Contestants are portrayed as ordinary people who have been given this grand opportunity to express and pursue their passion for music on stage. It is available to each individual with great passion for music. On the other hand, with the accelerated pace of life and work, people tend to go with music as a way to unwind or relax. As the famous saying goes, Music can heal bad times, cheer us up when sad, and bring us all together as humankind.

(2) What kinds of music do young people like?

Compared with the music that parents and elders had access to decades ago, the ways and types of music for the younger generation are, to be honest, very diversified, but the majority of them have similar appetite for music. Personally speaking, the most popular answer was rap. According to the recent data released in NetEase Cloud Music, the most popular music platforms in China overall, hip-hop/rap is the genre that is most consumed in Chinese young groups. This can be largely contributed by some rap shows around the world, be it The Rap of China or Wild N Out in the United States. Such kinda art form deeply reflects the way young people show to decompress when they're feeling tense and competitive.

15、一个去过的新地方

Describe a new place you

visited

You should say:

Where it is

When you went there

Why you went there

And explain how you feel about the place

我曾经去过清迈旅游。清迈以旅游胜地而闻名，有非常多著名的景点和美丽的景色。两年前，我和我的父母一起去那里度假，放松自己。我非常喜欢清迈。首先，清迈有非常宜人的气候，。此外，清迈的人都非常友善，那些餐馆和住处的服务员都非常热情。最后，清迈的美食都非常诱人，新鲜的海鲜和热辣的当地美食，总是让我非常有食欲。

I used to travel to Chiang Mai, which is a city in Thailand. Chiang Mai is a popular tourist destination with a variety of well-known attractions and **stunning scenery** **(惊人的景色)**. I went there for vacation with my parents two years ago. My parents were also very busy with work, and I am usually very

busy with my studies.

So, while I was on summer vacation, my parents each took a week off (请假一周) and we all went on a family vacation to Chiang Mai to relax. Chiang Mai is a city that I adore. To begin with, Chiang Mai has a tropical climate that is never cold (从不寒冷的热带天气). Furthermore, the people of Chiang Mai are extremely friendly, and the waiters in restaurants and hotels are willing to assist us with anything. . Finally, the food in Chiang Mai is extremely appealing (诱人的食物); fresh seafood and spicy local cuisine always makes me hungry. When I'm full, however, there's plenty of fresh fruit and ice cream to go around (享受).

I even wish I could go on vacation to Chiang Mai for some time every year and be able to lie in the sun and sunbathe and walk in slippers. I fell in love with Chiang Mai after only one week there, and I hope to return to explore more of the city in the future.

(1) Which do you prefer, living in a city or only visiting it as a tourist?

For a long time, I prefer to live in a city. Because living in a city gives me more time to explore the city in depth rather than just looking around and visiting various attractions on a set schedule. If I can stay in a city for a long time, I can try out various gourmet restaurants based on my own preferences, locate inaccessible but stunning scenic spots, and converse with various people on the street to learn about the city's culture and characteristics. If we are just tourists, we will most likely be able to appreciate the city's beauty on the surface but not its inner beauty.

(2) How do young children react when they go to school for the first time?

I believe that when young children go to school for the first time, they cry because they are afraid of the unknown. My mother told me that when I first started kindergarten, I cried as I stood at the door. Because children spend most

of their time at home before attending their first day of school. As a result, when the scene changes, they become terrified, and crying is a common expression of fear. At the same time, children often have the most contact with family members before starting school, and they may be nervous when meeting new friends and teachers.



16、别人给你的衣服

Describe an item of clothing that someone gave you

You should say:

What the clothing was

Who gave it to you

When you got it

And explain why this person gave you the clothing

我想和你分享我上个月收到的一套西装店定制的西服。它是我女朋友送给我的生日礼物。

老实说我一直觉得自己需要一套面料好的定制西装来应对一些见客户，作报告等重要场合，因此我很惊讶女朋友居然能够猜到我的想法选了这个礼物。说回这套西装，它是 100%绵羊毛的，抗皱又保暖。平驳领的设计腰部的内收拉长了腿部比例也更显头小。不得不说这件衣服无论从版型剪裁还是面料上都深得我心。

当我问起女朋友如何精确的知道我的尺寸之时，她说是偷偷从我衣柜里拿了一件现有的西装再根据平时对我的了解估算的，我不得不感叹她的良苦用心和惊人的观察力了。

I'd like to share with you a tailored suit(定制西装) that I received last month.

It was a birthday present from my girlfriend.

At that time, after we had my birthday dinner at the restaurant, she took out a large bag secretly, and said she had carefully selected this present for me. To be honest, I didn't think much of it(不以为然) when I caught a glimpse of(瞥见) the hanger inside the paper bag. I thought it was a normal coat or hoodie.

It was not until I opened the bag and found it was a bespoke suit and (直到...

才) I felt pleasantly surprised. To be honest, I always thought I needed a tailored suit made of good fabric for important occasions, like client meetings, presentations, etc. But that idea has always been put on hold, since I don't wear suits very often, so I was surprised my girlfriend was able to guess what I was thinking and chose this gift.

Speaking of the suit, it is made of 100% sheep wool and the VBC readymade fabric(定制面料) so gives it comfort, is wrinkle resistance(抗皱性) and has good air porosity(透气性). When it comes to the design, the waist is appropriately adducted(收腰) to shape the figure. The middle-high waist design of trousers improves the waistline and elongates the legs(拉长腿部比例). At the same time, the style of shoulder with a slightly wider flat collar, optimizes the ratio of head to shoulder(优化头肩比). All in all, I have to say that this suit has won my heart both in terms of pattern cutting(剪裁) and fabric. When I asked my girlfriend how she knew exactly what my size was, she said she secretly took a suit from my closet and estimated the size based on what she knew about me, which made me marvel at her genius tactic.

(1) Have you ever given clothes to others

I once gave my dad a down jacket for his birthday. At that time, he had to go on a business trip to Harbin for a month. The temperature in the north was much lower than that in my hometown, and my father was worried about lacking some warm clothes. This gave me the inspiration for the gift, so I searched and learned that goose down is the best quality, and the amount of lint also determine the warmth of clothing. Therefore, I went to the special jacket brand in the mall. After consulting the shop assistant, I chose a down jacket that was warm enough for my father. He was very happy when he received it and said that he could think of my love for him whenever he wore it.

(2) Why do people dress casually in every day life but dress formally at work

In fact, I think for most people, there is not much difference between the way people dress in every-day life and at work. In daily life, we often decide what to wear according to the occasion we are going to, who we are meeting and even the mood of the day. We are also tended to be influenced by stars and try different styles of dressing. While at work, most companies do not have very strict dress code, and smart casual is also a popular and highly-recognized style of dressing. On certain occasions, such as when there is an important report or meeting, people dress formally not only to give respect to others and show their professionalism, but also to give themselves confidence.

17、别人讲述的故事

Describe a story someone told you and remember

You should say:

What the story was about

Who told you this story

Why you remember it

And how you feel about it

我听过很多故事，至今依然记忆深刻的要数《伊索寓言》中《乌鸦喝水》的故事。我7岁的时候从父母那听来的这个故事。故事讲的是一只口渴的乌鸦到处找水喝，好不容易找到一个带水的罐子，却喝不到里面的水。乌鸦想尽办法，最终通过往罐子里投小石子使水面升高，成功喝到水。这则寓言故事很有启发性，它让我知道了遇到困难不能放弃，有志者事竟成，只要充分发挥智慧，问题总能解决。

To be honest, I've heard numerous stories since childhood and my favorite one comes from a collection of stories known as Aesop's Fables. It's about a thirsty crow which found an innovative(创新的) way to drink water from a container. I heard this story from my parents at the age of seven.

In the story, a crow that was about to die of thirst(渴死) was looking for water.

It was a scorching hot(酷热) summer day with gusty winds(狂风), and there was little water anywhere. The crow flew here and there looking for water, but found nothing. It seems that the crow was about to die of thirst, but it continued its search. And all of a sudden(突然之间), the crow found a pitcher with water in it. When it peeped into(朝.....张望) the jar, to its surprise it found a little water at the bottom of the jar. It tried with its heart and soul(全心全意) to reach the water level, but failed because the neck of the jar was too narrow for the crow to enter into it. Then it thought it had to leave the place without drinking. When it was about to fly off, a new plan came to its mind. It found some pebbles scattered(散落) around the jar. So, the crow picked the pebbles one by one and dropped them into the jar. As a result, the water level rose.. When the water came near its reach, the bird drank it and quenched its thirst(解渴) and flew away.

This story is extremely interesting and practical, as I have seen it at work in real life. It impressed me a lot because it explains that necessity is the mother of invention in a very simple manner. I have witnessed people becoming innovative during an emergency or necessity. Moreover, from this story, I can also say that where there is a will, there is a way(有志者，事竟成).

(1) Do young children like the same stories as older children?

Young children don't like the same stories as older children. There are three points to illustrate. First of all, as young children were born after older children, the things they are familiar with and they love, such as toys, cartoons and games, are quite different compared with things older children like. Second, the environment where young children grow up and the education they receive have also changed a lot. Therefore, their habits, hobbies and thoughts might also be different from that of older children. Third, young children may have listened to the stories older children once heard many times and they are tired of those

stories and need something new to enjoy.

(2) How has technology changed storytelling?

Technology has changed storytelling in two aspects. First, technology has diversified the ways of storytelling. In the past, parents or teachers told stories to children personally most of the time and thus they played the role of storyteller. But with the progress of technology, especially the development of the Internet, now it is quite convenient for parents or teachers to play audios or videos of different stories on such devices as mobile phones, table computers and so on. Second, technology has greatly enriched the content of storytelling. In the old days, the content of storytelling was limited as the main source was only books or stories passed down by word of mouth. Now things have changed. The search engines on the Internet can help us find millions of interesting stories. It totally depends on what kind of stories you like. We no longer need to repeat several same stories time after time. And children can have more fun through enjoying different stories.

18、社交媒体上常刷到的人

Describe a person who you follow on social media

You should say

Who he/she is

How you knew him/her

What he/she posts on social media

And explain why you follow him/her on social media

我想要分享罗翔，他是中国政法大学的法学教授，在 b 站上分享自己对于法律案件的见解。虽然作为一位高知和高流量播主，他一直保持低调。最特殊的地方在于他会用接地气的语言和例子来描述曾经对我们来说很高深的话题。比如法外狂徒张三，而且他是一个非常幽默诙谐的人，所以对于法律这样复杂的知识体系，很多观众也能觉得有趣。我成为他忠实的粉丝因为他的视频提高了我的法律意识，而且教会我遇到不公平的时候，不能保持沉默，而是要为了自己的权利而斗争。我被他的个人魅力折服了，把他推荐给了很多朋友。

So today I just want to share with you what I know about a honorable professor called Luo Xiang. I have known him for about three years since I started to use a smart phone . At first, I **bumped into him**(偶然遇到) giving a lecture in the Chinese University of Political Science and the Laws, I was really fascinated by his **humorous manner and profound knowledge**, (幽默诙谐 知识渊博) so I kept following him. Then accidentally, I saw a video clip on the online video platform called Bilibili, it's like YouTube in your culture. He was already a popular Internet influencer with more than **3 million followers** (三百万粉丝) , and in most of his videos he would use **an interesting imaginary figure** (有趣的虚构人物) called Zhangsang, who was like an average Joe, to illustrate some dos and don'ts in our daily life. Sometimes when I was staring at Mr Luo who kept a low profile, (保持低调) , I would feel his charm.

So, I've become a faithful follower. And almost every evening I would **scroll through the platform** (刷平台) and to **keep up with his latest videos** (看最新更新的视频) I would even take down some notes, simply because he devoted himself to **raising the awareness of abiding by the rules** (提高遵纪守法的意识) and he explained **a lot of difficult regulations** by using vivid examples. He encourages us to **fight for our rights** (争取权益) instead of keeping silent when meeting unfairness. With his help, I managed to build **a basic theoretical framework** (理论框架) of the law and political science, which helped me sort out some daily issues related to regulations. And I guess a lot of young people would follow him probably for the same reason, that he can simply help us understand something **seemingly out of reach** (似乎遥不可及) .

(1) Do you think older people and younger people will use the same kind of social media software?

Social media apps that both young people and old people use do have something in common. Basically they would both use them as daily necessity such as WhatsApp and WeChat to keep in touch with family members and best mates. But comparatively, it's more likely that young people would go for a variety of apps with more diverse functions such as trying different filters in the cameras, watching live streaming programmes and also they would probably try some dating apps to find their ideal partner. In order to provide our pensioners fascinating retirement life, maybe our young people could help them with complicated functions on the apps so that they may not be fearful of the fast-growing technology.

(2) Do older people spend much time on social media?

Well not exactly. They would employ some fundamental functions on those social media apps, and it is typical of him to get bewildered by the fast-growing technology. So a lot of my friends would go to their grannies to teach them how to use it and I think it's a good thing. Instead of surfing the Internet they would be more likely to stay at home and just watch the TV or maybe take a walk together after dinner, which is pretty common for the elderly in China. And a great phenomenon is that more and more older people are starting to use mobile phones and try to contact their beloved with the help of technology. And I could clearly remember how surprised my granny was the first time she started to use the video conference.

19、不喜欢的规则

Describe a rule that you don't like

You should say:

What it is

Why you don't like it

How others feel about the rule

And explain whether you've followed the rule

我很不喜欢上班打卡的规定，因为我觉得有时候晚几分钟上班，再晚几分钟下

班就行了，尤其是现在交通那么繁忙，很容易就挤不上车或者遇到堵车，然后就迟到了。我们公司的人几乎都认为这是一个不好的规定，觉得我们可以灵活调整上下班时间，这样就不会出现迟到的纪律。当然，老板不改规定我们也没办法，所以现在我还是在遵循上班打卡的规定。

Where I work now is a small private company, so they made a lot of their own rules about working. One of the rules I don't like the most is that you must clock in (打卡) work.

My company stipulates (规定) that if an employee is more than two minutes late in the morning, he or she will be deducted money (扣钱) each time, as well as the bonus at the end of the year. I don't think it's a humane rule (人性化的规定). On the contrary, the humanized stipulation (人性化的规定) should be that sometimes people can go to work a few minutes later and just let them get off work a few minutes later, as long as the total time meets the requirements of the contract (只要时长达到了合同的要求就行了). Because of the particularity (特殊性) of our company's business, employees do not need to arrive for work so early, and sometimes we even need to wait for feedback from other companies before continuing to work. Instead, we have to work overtime and that's a waste of time. We all know that traffic is so busy nowadays, especially during the morning rush hour (早高峰), that it is easy to get stuck on the bus (挤不上公交) or encounter traffic jams (遇上堵车), and even the subway is very crowded. As a girl, I often cannot get on the subway, and then I am late again! Even once I tried to go out half an hour earlier, but it was still very tight (时间非常紧) and I was nearly late.

Almost everyone in our company, except the boss, thinks this is a bad rule. Everyone has the experience of being late and being deducted, which has become the biggest complaint of employees. We've discussed privately and

thought we could flexibly adjust our commute time, (灵活调整通勤时间) so we don't get charged for being late. Of course, there is nothing we can do if the boss doesn't change the rules, so now I still follow the rules of clocking in every day.

(1) What are the rules students should follow at school?

I think students should abide by the school uniform rule and hairstyle rule. In fact, many people think that these regulations are very inhumane and that it is not conducive to the development of students' personality, but in fact, I reckon that the starting point of these regulations is very good. First of all, students have uniform clothing and hairstyles, so that they don't spend a lot of unnecessary time picking clothes each morning, or taking care of their hairstyles, and they can save more time for their studies. Secondly, uniform is also to prevent students from wearing clothes that do not conform to their identity and age, and to prevent students from competing with each other. Especially some fancy clothes or dyed hair are not suitable for students. These are the rule that a student should follow.

(2) Are the rules at school good or bad?

I think these rules are all good. The school set all the rules and regulations so that students can invest all the time in their studies and plan for their future, rather than focusing on unnecessary stuffs at their age, like clothing or an outstanding hairstyle. Wearing a school uniform is one of the external manifestations of the overall spiritual outlook of a school, it represents the school and it is also an integral part of the construction of campus culture. When students put on school uniforms, they will unconsciously pay attention to their words and deeds, especially when they are out of campus. On top of that, wearing uniforms at school can give students a sense of equality with each other, and it is easy to form a harmonious atmosphere of cooperation, unity and respect. So I think those rules are all good.

20、向长者学习技能

Describe a skill that you can learn from older people

You should say:

Why the skill can be learned from older people

How you will learn the skill from older people

And explain how you will feel if you master the skill



我以及我身边的朋友们现在基本上是手机不离手，一旦找不但手机就急得团团转，但其实很多时候，我们越刷手机反而越觉得内心空虚。而大部分的老一辈的人们却不是这样子，他们基本上不怎么用手机，就算用也只是打打电话，联系他人，他们的快乐并不建立在玩手机上，没有手机他们也能生活充实。

The skill that I hope to learn from older people is to live life meaningfully without constantly checking mobile phones.

Nowadays, it seems that me and my friends are all tethered to our phones. We would be so out of our element once our devices are out of our reach. But the truth is that the more we scroll social media, the emptier we feel deep inside. By contrast, the older generation like my grandparents, do not have this morbid relationship with smart phones. Most of them only use these devices for making phone calls. Apparently playing on phones is not the source of their happiness. They have their ways of fulfilling their everyday life, which is what I admire.

In order to acquire this ability, I believe the first step is to have a close observation on the elder's lifestyle and their attitude towards those daily details. For me, I plan to spend more time with my grandpa, so that I could get an idea of how he arranges his life without a mobile phone, and how he sets his priorities in his daily routine. By doing so, hopefully I could draw some inspiration and incorporate them into my own life.

I firmly believe that if I could make the most of my time without repeatedly checking those social platforms on my phone, then my mental status would be

healthier and more peaceful. My source of joy will not morbidly depend on those superficial materials or affirmations from other people. I could be my own supplier of happiness and confidence. Also, this skill will give me a crystal idea of what is actually beneficial to my personal development.

(1) What skills can young people learn from older people?



Well, I believe there are tons of things that we children can learn from the elderly. They have experienced so much more than we do, and they probably have encountered similar problems as us when they were young, so there must be a lot that we can learn from them, like how to deal with the job interview, how to organize our finance and so on. Take myself as an example. I always admire my parents' ability to maintain the work-life balance. I personally find it hard to deal with my study and leisure time, so it is incredible that they can take care of this family as well as perform well in their jobs. I would always like to pick their brain and improve myself for the better.

(2) What can children learn from their parents ?

Well, I don't really think people can actually put a number on how much they can learn from their parents and how much from grandparents. Lessons that are acquired from either parents or grandparents are equally valueless. Maybe along certain points in our life we will lean more on our parents' advice because we are experiencing similar situations as they once did. But when life turns a corner, we may find our grandparents are a more informative source of suggestions. For example, when I encounter some problems about my work or the interpersonal relationship, I would turn to my parents, because the work environment may have changed greatly from that of my grandparents' time. But my grandparents are also wonderful teachers in teaching me how to live a meaningful life without attaching to mobile phones, which is valuable as well.

21、有趣的城市

Describe a city that you think is interesting

You should say:

Where it is

What the city is famous for

Why it is interesting

And explain how you feel about it



我想讲的是清迈，泰国的一个城市。我去年冬天和朋友一起去清迈玩，那里的寺庙很出名。除此之外，感觉那里非常朴素，很有生活情调。有趣的是，在这样一个具有泰式风情的城市，有很多外国人。街上随处都是来自其它国家的人，讲着各种语言。那里的夜生活也很有意思，街边有很多卖小吃的，东西不贵。如果去市区，还有很多装饰美丽的酒吧。我在那里了一星期，非常放松，享受。

I'm going to talk about Chiang Mai, which is one of the most visited cities in Thailand. I first went there with two other friends last winter. Well, we left the country while it was snowing, and landed in warm weather there. The weather in Chiang Mai was so pleasant! I loved it!

So, the place is famous for its various temples because the Buddhism thoughts were prevalent (流行) in Thailand. And Chiang Mai was certainly the must-go place if you wanted to experience the genuine Buddhism temples. We had some conversations with a few pious (虔诚的) local Buddha believers while we were visiting the temples. They were so friendly and kind. Even China is also a big country for Buddhism culture, I must admit, I've never met such devout (虔诚的) Buddhists.

Apart from the temples, the lifestyle there is so enjoyable and low cost. I guess that's one of the reasons why it attracted so many foreigners to live there. Walking on the street, you could hear at least ten different languages while people were passing by and talking. It was amazing to experience the rich

language diversity!(能体会这种语言多样化真的太棒了) I don't think there's a city like that anywhere in China. Well, at least, that was the first time I ever had such an experience!

Another interesting aspect about it were the nicely decorated bars in the city area. They seemed to always be full of customers, of different nationalities (酒吧总是很满，坐着各种肤色的顾客) People were enjoying the wine there, rather than drinking for business. Well, that's what the wine culture is in China. For the first time, I realized that an enjoyable life is created by yourself, rather than handed to you by others. I totally loved the night life there. I stayed there for about a weekend the entire week, I was in a great mood, and enjoyed every moment of the day!

(1) What advantages can tourism bring to a city ?

Well, I think when a city opens its door to welcome the outsiders, it's ready to expand and broaden its own perspectives as well. The travelers can bring in so much diversity to the local culture, so the local culture can become mixed and the local people get to experience daily changes and updates. It can be an amazing experience for the tourist city! Also, the boosting of tourism industry in a city could accelerate the place's economic development to some degree. So the life quality there could be improved as well.

(2) Why do some young people like to live in cities ?

Yeah, it's for sure that cities do attract the vast majority of young graduates nowadays. I think one of the reasons is that most prestigious universities are located in big cities, therefore it's more convenient for young people to just stay there after graduation. You know, while you are already familiar with the city and moving can be troublesome, why bother? Another good reason is that young people are usually more into fast-paced lifestyles. In the city, everything is processed faster than in the countryside. Many young people appreciate the

efficiency and they simply want to be part of it.

22、印象深刻的课程

Describe a course that impressed you a lot

You should say:

What the course was about

Where you took the course

What you did during the course

And explain why it impressed you a lot



我想说的是我大二时选修的高级英语课程。我们老师是一个刚从新西兰留学回来的女孩，非常时尚，思想开放。经常在课堂上给我们讲她自己在国外的经历。一般上课老师都是非常严肃的，而且严格按照课本讲。这个老师打破常规，让我有耳目一新的感觉。我觉得我在那个课上，收获的远远不止英语，还有国际化的视野和对外面世界的好奇心。

I want to talk about the English course I took back when I was a sophomore. Well, the name of the course was Advanced English, and it was actually a selective course(选修课). I initially chose it because I thought it would be easy to pass with flying colors. because you know, I was quite confident in my English. You see, I was not expecting it to be the most impressive course in my course calendar.

Anyways, it was not really the course content(课程内容) that's so worth mentioning. The textbook was no different than any English textbooks you see at university, and really it aimed to teach advanced vocabulary and grammar patterns(课程内容主囊高级词汇和语法规则的). But that was it. What made the course such a valuable asset was the teacher!(老师才是这个课程的真正宝贵资源) She studied and lived in New Zealand for eight years, and it was her first year of teaching. She treated us like friends, rather than

students. After all, she was only five years older than us. Unlike most rigid lecturers who would go on about the boring bullet points (无聊的重点) over and over again, she shared with us so many interesting experiences she had overseas. Apparently, New Zealand also had minority people, and they were called Māori's . Also, some New Zealanders thought Chinese medicine was some sort of witchcraft (巫术) because it seemed like magic to their health and wellbeing! Besides, every house in New Zealand has a garden. And if you don't take care of your garden, you can be fined by the community! Because you must fulfill your obligation to create a pleasant view for your neighbors!

For the first time, I was intrigued in the foreign world! And also for the first time, I realized that the world is so diverse and worth seeing. I'm really glad that I took that course!

(1) Why do some people have better memory?

Ah, that's an interesting question. I've never thought about this before. Indeed, some people seem to have the ability to memorize things quickly and well. I reckon they must have mastered some kind of pattern. As far as I understand, human brains operate in certain ways. Some people may have been lucky to have found the secret operation pattern that they can manipulate their brains to memorize things more efficiently. Apart from that, I think any human beings would need to constantly review things in order to remember them. Those who claim they have a poor memory don't review things often enough, I can at least say that. And the ones that have better memory review things more often.

(2) Do people like things of memorial significance?

Well, I think most people do give special attention to things that are of special meanings to them. For example, a pearl necklace from someone's great grandmother may be a family treasure, and has been passed down for many generations. Such a piece has seen hundreds or even thousands of years of

history. Not to mention its great money value given that it's an antique, but the spiritual value it brings to the family is unmeasurable. So I imagine anyone who's handed over this precious piece would be thrilled and treat it with special care, to celebrate its memorial significance.



23、收到特殊蛋糕

Describe a special cake you received from others

You should say

When it happened

Where it happened

Who you got the cake from

And explain why it's a special cake

我大学室友是个非常积极乐观的女孩儿，她曾经说过她的梦想就是能够经营一家自己喜爱的甜品店。毕业之后我们留在了同一座城市但是选择了不同的公司工作。去年我生日的时候收到了来自好友的蛋糕，蛋糕上附有一张小卡片，原来她真的如愿以偿去创业了，并且开了属于自己的甜品店。这是我收到过最为特别的蛋糕，因为它不仅是我们的友谊的见证，更是我们实现梦想的证明，我真心为她开心。

I have received many birthday cakes but the most special one was on my birthday last year, it was from my best friend Sue, who was my roommate at college. The story is quite unforgettable. Sue had been optimistic and it seemed that she was always **carefree** (无忧无虑), which attracted me a lot since we first met each other. She once mentioned that her dream was to possess a bakery store **on her own** (属于她自己的). But after graduation we **departed** (离开) for both she and I chose companies to work for. Sue worked in the HR department in a large **joint venture** (合资企业), which, at that moment, was a satisfying offer for graduates.

But one day last year in my office, I suddenly received an exquisitely wrapped package with a note from Sue, reading that she had **resigned from** (辞职) the

firm and established her own bakery store. She told me that it took her a long time to make the final decision because it meant that she had to restart from zero, and moreover, it was more likely that she would face failure. But nothing could stop her from pursuing her dream. Up to then she had achieved good results and her business **was on track** (步入正轨) **Tears welled up** (泪水涌入眼眶) upon reading those lines, because I could totally understand her, and more importantly, I felt proud of her from the bottom of my heart.

To my great surprise, the cake was both beautiful and tasty . I consider it to be the most special gift that I have ever received. That's because the cake witnessed the friendship between us and moreover, it inspires me to keep up with Sue to stick to my dreams and goals.

(1)What is the difference between special food in China and foreign countries? Obviously there are many differences between special food in China and foreign countries. To be specific, they are different in cooking methods, Chinese food are famous for various means of cooking such as steaming , frying, braising and so forth while foreign food are more often cooked by boiling. What's more, Chinese food and foreign ones are different in flavour, you know, in China there are eight main regional cuisines which are characterized by different taste, either spicy or sweet. But foreign food are in general mild tasting. Al in all , although differences exist, both Chinese and foreign food are popular in the world.

(2)Do people usually cook special food in China?

Actually the it's not an absolute answer because the circumstance vary from region to region. Based on my knowledge and personal experience, eastern people are more likely to try new things and they like to cook special food such as different seafood and cuisines. While in most northern parts, people are more keen on their own taste and food, people like to cook routinely so they rarely try

those special food. But as the internet is so popular these days, I think people are easily to change these eating habits. And what's more, more and more families could afford to buy some uncommon ingredients to cook something special. So I think it all depends.



24、送朋友的礼物

Describe a gift you gave to a friend

You should say:

When it happened

What gift it was

Who you gave it to

And explain why you chose that gift

在我大学出国交换的时候，去佛罗里达听了泰勒斯威夫特的巡回演唱会。结束后在逛纪念品商店时，我发现有限量版的专辑，上面还有泰勒的亲笔签名。我买了一张回国后送给了我的发小，因为她从初中开始就是泰勒的铁杆粉丝，为此在职业规划上也选择了音乐创作。我送给她这份礼物是想鼓励她追逐梦想。

When I was on exchange to in America at university, I once traveled to Florida for Taylor Swift's tour (巡回演唱会). Her live show was fantastic and reminded me of many memories in my adolescence. After the concert, I went into the souvenir shop (纪念品商店) to have a look around.

There was a lot of co-branded (联名的) merchandise like T-shirt, cups, and posters. At the same time, I noticed some displayed CDs on the shelf which were of limited edition (限量版) with Taylor's autograph (亲笔签名) on it. I bought one and decided to give it to one of my childhood friends after I went back to China, because she was a big fan of Taylor Swift since junior high.. Due to such passion, she was determined to work on music production. And now, she has established a musical workshop with some ambitious instrumentalists (乐器手) and producers. She has the talent in lyric writing (作曲) and singing, with the preference of country and jazz music.

I think she has a lot of similarities with Taylor Swift, because they both like to

play guitar and started from nothing as a musician. Therefore, I hoped the CD I bought for her could encourage her on the pursuit of her music dream and recall those memories we had in high school. She will achieve her ambition for sure and have her own concert.

(1) when do people normally sent gifts to others?



Same with all the other traditions in the world, people sent presents to their friends and families on birthday. During anniversaries, couples also give presents to each other in the name of love. Meanwhile, Chinese people often give gifts during Spring festival as well. The spring festival is on the last day of the year according to the Chinese calendar, so adults always carry gifts with them when they go back home as a tradition to celebrate the family reunion. And in some areas, after man and woman are engaged with each other, the man's family will send wedding presents, which are also called as the bride price, to the woman's family before the marriage.

(2) Do people give gifts or red pockets on traditional festivals?

Well, I have to say giving red pockets is a tradition especially in China. During each Spring festival, adults will put some money in the red pocket and give it to all the children in the family. Money is of great importance and valued a lot by Chinese people to some extent, so giving them away shows care and love for the younger generation. By contrast, western people like to send presents to each other on traditional festivals like Christmas by putting them under the Christmas tree. They enjoy the process of selecting a present for their friends and the feeling of unwrapping an unknown gift.

25、一见且想再见的人

Describe a person you only met once and want to know more again

You should say:

Who he/she is

When you met him/her

Why you want to know more about him/her

And explain how you feel about him/her

我想说的是我在参加英语角活动时遇到的留学生Rick。那是在我高二的时候，我和同学想练习英语口语。当我们听说当地图书馆在周末会举办英语角时，我们立刻报名了。到了英语角现场，我们是那里唯一高中生打扮的人，因为太紧张了我们不敢去外国朋友面前介绍自己。看到我们的窘态，一个看上去人很好很开朗的留学生主动过来自我介绍，他就是 Rick。Rick 说自己来自荷兰，现在在中国学习心理学。我发现我们居然都对实验心理学的理论非常感兴趣，于是聊得很投机。Rick 还邀请了几个很亲切的外国留学生来和我们聊天，听我们自我介绍。如果我们卡住了，他主动地给我们翻译，教我们一些词语。很可惜，我走的时候太匆忙，没有和他交换联系方式。我很想再见 Rick 一面，想对他亲自说声感谢，他的帮助令我记忆犹新。

I'd like to talk about an international student I met. His name is Rick. It was my second year in high school. To practice oral English, my classmate and I seized the opportunity (抓紧机会) to sign up for the English corner activity in local library. When we arrived at the English corner, we were surprised to find that we were the only two who dressed like high school students.

We were too nervous to make any self-introductions (做自我介绍) in front of the foreigners. That was when Rick saw us and came up for help. He said he was from The Netherlands and was studying psychology in China. I found that both of us were interested in theories of experimental psychology, so we felt like old friends at the first meeting (一见如故).

Rick not only chatted with us kindly to ease tension (缓解紧张), but also invited some friendly international students to chat with (聊天) us and helped our self-introduction. When our minds were blank (大脑一片空白), Rick would offer to translate for us and teach us some expressions. Finally, we

were able to say something in English fluently, and all the foreigners present gave us a round of applause (掌声雷动) and smiled kindly.

It was a pity that I left in a hurry and forgot to exchange contact information with Rick. I really want to meet Rick again to thank him in person, and wish him all the best, whether he is in China or in The Netherlands. It is so kind of him and I can remember this experience as if it were yesterday (记忆犹新).

(1)How do people make friends in China?

There are many ways for people to make friends in China, and it varies from people with different ages and genders. Here I would like to talk about it on the level of personal character. If you are shy, you would definitely start off with your inner circle of friends – people that you are more familiar with. You may get acquainted with your friends' friends and then be invited to go out. If you are an outgoing person, quite easy to talk with, probably you will extend your social circle by attending parties, workshops or some courses, visiting bars and clubs and of course, using online communities like WeChat and Tik Tok.

(2)On what occasions do people like to make friends?

I suppose the answer to this question may vary from person to person. What I mean by that is people of different ages may have their different choices to get to know someone new. For the kids, they prefer to make friends in their school with those who can have fun with them or even help them solve a math problem. But the adult may go with a completely different occasion to develop their friendship. It can be created either at dining table, say, for business cooperation, or sometimes be with friends with someone who joins the same interest clubs. Older people like my grandpa tend to make friends in some community activities, such as square dance, fishing and stuff like that held by the community.